

UAB

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona

Master-Thesis

**AI Corporate Governance versus Sustainability Corporate Governance:
An Integrative Literature Review**

MSc. In Management, Organization and Business Economics

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona
Universitat Pública de Navarra
Universitat de les Illes Balears

Submitted by:
Larissa Gagesch

Supervisor:
Nour Chams

Barcelona, 25/08/2026

Abstract

Artificial intelligence (AI) governance and sustainability governance have developed as largely separate research streams, publishing in different venues and rarely citing one another, despite both addressing how organizations respond to external pressures for accountability and legitimacy. This thesis conducts an integrative literature review of 93 empirical articles, using a keyword strategy developed from ten Financial Times Top 50 anchor articles and a theoretical framework grounded in Institutional Theory to compare the two fields. Guided by three propositions concerning institutional depth, symbolic versus substantive conformity, and convergence over time, the review develops a keyword-based search strategy across Scopus and Web of Science, followed by a thematic synthesis organized around five recurring themes and three broader clusters spanning AI governance, sustainability governance, and their interface. The reviewed literature is predominantly quantitative, with 65 of the 93 studies using quantitative designs, particularly panel-regression designs based on archival data. Mixed-methods and qualitative designs remain comparatively rare, while 59 of the 93 articles were published in 2025 or 2026, reflecting the recent emergence of AI governance as a research field. The findings show that sustainability governance has more developed institutional mechanisms, including established reporting systems, board responsibilities, stakeholder oversight, and regulatory mandates, whereas AI governance is still developing comparable structures around algorithmic accountability, transparency, and decision-right allocation. Symbolic and substantive conformity coexist within both fields rather than separating cleanly along field lines. The two fields share governance mechanisms, including disclosure, board oversight, regulation, and auditing, but transfer between them is conditional rather than automatic. AI-specific characteristics, including algorithmic opacity, rapid technological change, continuous learning, and unclear boundaries between human and system responsibility, require existing mechanisms to be adapted rather than adopted wholesale. The thesis concludes that sustainability governance offers a useful point of comparison for AI governance, but not a model that can be copied without qualification. It therefore proposes a conceptual model identifying the organizational, institutional, and technological conditions under which governance mechanisms are most and least likely to transfer successfully in practice.

Keywords: artificial intelligence governance, sustainability governance, institutional theory, corporate governance, integrative literature review

Table of Contents

1. Introduction	4
2. Theoretical Framework	6
2.1 Institutional Theory.....	6
2.2 Stakeholder Theory	9
2.3 Article-Level Propositions	10
2.4 Propositions Guiding the Thematic Synthesis	12
3. Methodology.....	13
3.1 Methodological Mechanics: Completeness, Balance, and Thematic Synthesis	15
3.2 Search Strategy and Keyword Selection	16
Table 1. Keyword Selection from the Ten FT50 Anchor Articles.....	18
3.3 Databases and Search Procedure.....	18
3.4 Filtering Criteria.....	18
3.5 Sample Size and Screening	19
3.6 Search Results	20
Table 2. Records by Cluster and Database	20
Figure 1. PRISMA-style flow diagram of the search, screening and inclusion process.....	21
Table 3. Search Results Summary	22
Figure 2. Distribution of Sample Articles by Research Method	23
Figure 4. Distribution of Sample Articles by Publication Year	25
Table 4. Synthesized Research Gaps and Future Research Directions by Cluster .	28
4. Thematic Synthesis	29
5. Limitations	41
6. Conclusion	42
Figure 5. Conceptual Model of Governance Mechanism Transfer from Sustainability to AI Governance	42
References.....	45

1. Introduction

Artificial intelligence (AI) has become one of the most influential technologies shaping modern organizations. Companies increasingly use AI-based systems to improve decision-making, automate processes, increase efficiency, and create competitive advantages (Ahdadou et al., 2025). At the same time, organizations face growing pressure from stakeholders, regulators, and society to address sustainability challenges and demonstrate responsible environmental, social, and governance (ESG) practices (Eccles et al., 2014; Buchetti et al., 2025).

The rapid adoption of AI presents both opportunities and challenges for sustainability governance. On the one hand, AI can support organizations in achieving sustainability objectives through improved data analysis, resource optimization, and monitoring capabilities. On the other hand, concerns have emerged regarding transparency, accountability, ethical implications, energy consumption, and governance mechanisms associated with AI deployment (Batoool et al., 2025; Bohnsack et al., 2026).

While the literature on AI governance and the literature on sustainability governance have both grown significantly in recent years, these streams of research have often developed independently. They publish in largely separate venues and rarely cite one another. This thesis assesses this separation systematically through the search and citation patterns reported in Section 3.2. Corporate governance refers broadly to the structures, rules, and mechanisms through which firms are directed, monitored, and controlled (Gillan, 2006). It has traditionally focused on internal mechanisms such as board structure and managerial incentives, as well as external mechanisms such as capital markets and regulation. AI governance extends this framework by addressing how firms design structures, policies, and controls to oversee the development and use of AI systems. This includes issues such as algorithmic accountability, data privacy, and ethical risk management (Batoool et al., 2025). Conversely, sustainability governance places significant emphasis on board oversight of ESG performance, stakeholder engagement, and sustainability disclosure. This approach is deeply entrenched in regulatory frameworks and investor expectations (Eccles et al., 2014; Buchetti et al., 2025). Despite their shared emphasis on accountability, transparency, and long-term value creation, the two approaches differ in scope, regulatory maturity, and theoretical foundations, leaving a fragmented picture of their relationship within organizational contexts.

This integrative literature review aims to synthesize existing knowledge at the intersection of these two governance paradigms. Specifically, it seeks to answer the following research questions: (1) *What are the conceptual and practical differences between AI corporate governance and sustainability corporate governance?* and (2) *To what extent do they overlap or complement each other?*

Despite the growing importance of both fields, three research gaps remain underexplored. First, the two governance paradigms have rarely been studied comparatively: scholars tend to work within one field of study without engaging with the theoretical contributions of other fields. For instance, Berente et al.'s (2021) foundational treatment of AI governance in *MIS Quarterly* and Eccles et al.'s (2014) influential study of sustainability governance in *Management Science*, despite both appearing among this thesis's ten FT50 anchor articles, share no common citations and do not engage with each other's theoretical vocabulary. Second, the potential for mutual reinforcement between AI governance and sustainability governance has received little attention. It remains unclear whether AI oversight mechanisms could inform ESG reporting frameworks, or how sustainability governance structures might guide responsible AI design. Third, the simultaneous digitalization and green transformation of firms, what is commonly referred to in the literature as the 'twin transition' (Bohnsack et al., 2026), creates new governance challenges that neither paradigm alone is equipped to address.

The review contributes to the literature in four ways. It provides a structured comparison of AI governance and sustainability governance across theoretical foundations, governance mechanisms, and regulatory context. The thematic synthesis is organized around five recurring themes, that map the empirical focus of the literature, while the research-gaps analysis draws on three broader clusters that identify where existing evidence is concentrated and where important omissions remain. Following the integrative review methodology of Cronin and George (2020), this review also brings together two communities of practice that have developed in parallel, showing where substantive tensions remain. A further contribution is the conceptual model, which specifies the organizational, institutional, and technological conditions under which governance mechanisms may transfer from sustainability governance to AI governance. These conditions are intended to guide future empirical testing rather than to be presented as empirically established relationships. Finally, the review identifies six concrete gaps for future research: AI governance institutionalization and reporting, nonlinear adoption effects, ESG measurements and rating disagreement, the

conditional effectiveness of governance mechanisms, the organizational embedding of AI, and the distinction between substantive and symbolic AI-enabled sustainability practices.

2. Theoretical Framework

The present thesis adopts Institutional theory, specifically the concepts of institutionalization and organizational legitimacy, as the primary framework for comparing and integrating AI governance and sustainability governance.

2.1 Institutional Theory

Several theoretical frameworks could be applied to this comparison. This thesis does not focus on agency theory, which concerns the internal relationship between a firm's owners and its managers. This thesis uses Institutional theory as the main framework because it directly addresses its central questions: why do AI governance and sustainability governance differ conceptually and practically, and why might these two governance domains develop independently before converging? Institutional theory holds that organizations adopt structures to be perceived as legitimate by their environment, regardless of whether those structures are the most technically efficient solution (DiMaggio & Powell, 1983; Suchman, 1995). This means AI governance and sustainability governance do not need to share a common technical vocabulary or regulatory history to be compared, both can instead be read as expressions of the same underlying mechanism, operating at different stages of institutionalization. This integration across two communities of practice, which have developed largely in parallel, is precisely the kind of synthesis aimed at redirection, rather than adjudication, that Cronin and George (2020) describe as the central purpose of an integrative review.

DiMaggio and Powell (1983) advanced the concept of organizational isomorphism within specific fields, proposing that organizations tend to adopt similar structures over time through three distinct mechanisms: coercive isomorphism, driven by regulatory or legal constraints; mimetic isomorphism, driven by the imitation of peers in uncertain environments; and normative isomorphism, driven by professional norms and standards. Suchman (1995) distinguishes three types of legitimacy: pragmatic legitimacy, which depends on whether an audience sees benefit for itself, moral legitimacy, which depends on whether an action is judged appropriate according to social norms, and cognitive legitimacy,

which depends on whether an organization's existence is taken for granted as self-evident. Collectively, these two contributions imply that governance structures emerge less because they are the most efficient solution to a given problem and more because they signal conformity with prevailing institutional expectations. However, this legitimacy-oriented understanding also requires caution regarding how sustainability performance is measured. Drempetic et al. (2020) argue that larger companies may receive more favourable ESG evaluations because they have greater capacity to produce and disclose sustainability-related information. Their findings therefore point to a size-related bias in ESG ratings and suggest that reporting capacity can influence how organizational sustainability is assessed.

The comparison developed in this thesis suggests that the three mechanisms of institutional isomorphism operate differently across AI governance and sustainability governance. Coercive isomorphism appears more established in sustainability governance, where mandatory ESG disclosure regimes create formal reporting expectations and, in some contexts, encourage firms to establish related reporting and oversight processes, although the strength of these pressures varies across jurisdictions (DiMaggio & Powell, 1983; Aboud et al., 2024; Eccles et al., 2014). Comparable coercive structures have not yet become established in AI governance. Although responsible AI principles and governance frameworks are increasingly available, their translation into regular organizational practice remains limited (Papagiannidis et al., 2025). Mimetic isomorphism may be particularly salient in AI governance because shared governance templates have not yet stabilized. Under these conditions, observing and imitating peer organizations may provide a way to signal legitimacy. This is a theoretically informed expectation derived from Institutional theory, rather than a relationship directly tested by the reviewed studies (DiMaggio & Powell, 1983). Normative isomorphism also appears more established in sustainability governance, where professional expectations and organizational practices relating to stakeholder engagement, measurement, disclosure, and board responsibility support shared governance standards (Eccles et al., 2014). Taken together, these differences provide a theoretical explanation for the institutional depth proposed in this thesis.

Symbolic and Substantive Conformity to Institutional Pressure

Peters and Romi (2014) provide empirical evidence that organizations may adopt formal governance mechanisms in response to environmental and institutional pressures without necessarily ensuring transparent disclosure. Their findings show that the presence of environmental committees and chief sustainability officers increases the likelihood that firms disclose greenhouse gas emissions. The likelihood of disclosure also increases with committee size, meeting frequency, member expertise, and overlap with the audit committee. However, the factors associated with disclosure are not identical to those associated with transparency. While member expertise is particularly important for improving transparency, larger committees may be associated with lower levels of transparency. These findings indicate that the formal adoption of governance structures does not automatically ensure that organizations produce high-quality or transparent environmental information. Instead, the effectiveness of such mechanisms depends on the expertise and the organizational conditions that support their implementation.

Durand, Hawn, and Ioannou (2019) provide a broader conceptual explanation for this distinction by arguing that organizational responses to normative pressures depend on both willingness and ability. Willingness is shaped by how salient an issue appears to decision-makers, whereas ability depends on the perceived costs and benefits of mobilizing resources to address it. Based on the interaction between these factors, organizations may engage in symbolic compliance, symbolic conformity, substantive compliance, substantive conformity or inaction. Their model therefore explains why organizations exposed to similar institutional pressures may respond in different ways. Some organizations may adopt visible structures or practices primarily to demonstrate conformity, while others may mobilize the necessary resources to implement meaningful change. Taken together with the findings of Peters and Romi (2014) this perspective shows that the existence of governance mechanisms or public disclosures should not be treated as evidence of substantive performance. The distinction between formal conformity and effective implementation consequently provides an important foundation for examining how organizations respond to stakeholder expectations and pressures.

Institutional Maturity and the AI Governance Gap

The distinction between symbolic and substantive conformity is also relevant to sustainability reporting. Stacchezzini, Melloni, and Lai's (2016) research indicates that integrated reports offer a limited amount of quantitative and forward-looking information regarding sustainability actions and performance. They further show that such disclosures may function as impression-management strategies rather than as evidence of genuine sustainability management.

Sustainability governance is a comparatively mature institutional field. Reporting standards, board-level oversight structures, and regulatory mandates (e.g., mandatory greenhouse gas disclosure) have already been established. Consequently, firms operating within this field can be observed moving from symbolic to more substantive forms of conformity and compliance as the issue has become institutionalized over time. In contrast, the domain of AI governance is a relatively recent development. Building on this theoretical distinction, the database search conducted for the overlap cluster offers a preliminary and narrowly scoped indication of differences in institutional maturity. The literature explicitly addressing the intersection of AI governance and sustainability governance is largely found outside core business journals. The most thematically relevant articles are indexed under environmental science categories rather than business or management. While this pattern speaks only to the overlap between the two fields and not to the institutionalization of AI governance, it suggests that integrated AI-sustainability governance mechanisms have not yet reached the same degree of institutionalization as sustainability governance on its own. Applying Durand et al.'s (2019) model to the AI context, the available evidence is consistent with the possibility that AI governance responses remain more symbolic than substantive at this stage, even where the perceived salience of AI-related risk is high.

2.2 Stakeholder Theory

As a secondary, complementary lens, this thesis also draws on stakeholder theory (Freeman, 1984), which posits that firms are accountable not only to shareholders but also to a broader set of constituencies affected by or able to affect organizational outcomes. Institutional theory and Stakeholder theory address related but distinct questions about why organizations face normative and societal pressures. Institutional theory provides a comprehensive framework for understanding why organizational structures converge in the first place.

Stakeholder theory, by contrast, offers a more targeted explanation by identifying the actors who exert pressure on organizations and the mechanisms through which certain stakeholder groups, including regulators, investors, employees, and civil society, shape the legitimacy assessments that Institutional theory describes. The two lenses are therefore treated as complementary rather than competing: Institutional theory provides the primary explanatory mechanism for this thesis, while Stakeholder theory is used where relevant to clarify which external actors are driving a given governance response. In the AI governance literature, this typically means regulators and civil-society actors pressing for algorithmic accountability; in the sustainability governance literature, it more often means investors and NGOs pressing for ESG disclosure.

This theoretical framework also provides a foundation for understanding why this thesis treats AI governance and sustainability governance as related manifestations of institutional dynamics rather than as two unrelated fields. Both can be understood as organizational responses to institutional pressures for legitimacy amid rising scrutiny and uncertainty. They differ, however, in the extent to which these pressures have become institutionalized and in the maturity of the governance mechanisms through which organizations respond.

2.3 Article-Level Propositions

The following propositions apply the Institutional theory framework developed above to each of the ten FT50 articles forming the basis of the thematic synthesis in the next section. The propositions are formulated as interpretive statements, expectations derived from theory, rather than as findings independently established by the cited studies.

AI Governance Cluster

Berente et al. (2021): Following Institutional theory, Berente, Gu, Recker, and Santhanam (2021) observe that managing AI "can never be finished" (p. 1437) and instead remains an ongoing process of emergence, with existing research offering little guidance for managers beyond basic compliance. This is consistent with AI governance being at an early, pre-institutionalized stage, in which normative templates for managing AI have not yet stabilized.

Tong et al. (2021): In accordance with the principles of Institutional theory, the simultaneous existence of a positive deployment effect and a negative disclosure effect of

AI feedback, as documented by Tong, Jia, Luo, and Fang (2021), is consistent with a field in which substantive adoption of AI (deployment) is outpacing the development of normative templates for how such adoption should be communicated (disclosure). Tong et al. (2021) attribute this discrepancy to employees' psychological aversion to AI feedback. However, an institutional reading suggests that the same pattern is also consistent with a field that has not yet undergone institutionalization. In such a case, organizations have not yet established normative standards for communicating AI's role in managerial decisions.

Abbasi et al. (2024): Abbasi, Parsons, Pant, Liu Sheng, and Sarker (2024) identify six major impediments to publishing AI design research in information systems journals. Following Institutional theory, this pattern is consistent with the absence of normative isomorphism in AI-related scholarship, that is, professional norms and evaluative standards for this kind of research have not yet stabilized across the field.

Caro et al. (2026): According to Institutional theory, the editors' framing of the human-algorithm relationship as still requiring foundational conceptual work (Caro et al., 2026) aligns with the concept that AI governance occupies an early position on the institutionalization continuum. From this perspective AI Governance is prior to the emergence of widely shared cognitive legitimacy regarding appropriate human-algorithm arrangements.

Sustainability Governance Cluster

Eccles et al. (2014): Following Institutional theory, the finding that “High Sustainability” firms exhibit formalized board responsibility for sustainability and executive compensation tied to sustainability metrics (Eccles, Ioannou, & Serafeim, 2014) reflects substantive, rather than merely symbolic, conformity in a field where sustainability governance has become comparatively institutionalized.

Liang & Renneboog (2017): Institutional theory suggests that a firm's CSR rating is significantly influenced by the legal origins of the country in which it is based (Liang & Renneboog, 2017). This finding aligns with the notion of coercive institutionalism operating within national institutional environments rather than solely at the level of the individual firm.

Bolton & Kacperczyk (2021): Institutional theory suggests that the finding that firms with higher carbon emissions earn a return premium (Bolton & Kacperczyk, 2021) can also be interpreted in a different way. This suggests that capital markets may act as an institutional pressure mechanism, pricing legitimacy-related risk before formal regulatory mandates fully institutionalize carbon disclosure.

Theoretical / Overlap Cluster

Durand, Hawn, & Ioannou (2019): As the central theoretical framework, Durand et al. (2019) demonstrate that organizations facing similar levels of issue salience can still diverge in their responses, depending on cost-benefit thresholds and on how different decision-makers perceive those costs and benefits. This thesis utilizes their model as a foundation for a comparative analysis of the relative institutional maturity of AI governance and sustainability governance.

Berrone et al. (2013): According to institutional theory, environmental innovation is driven by regulatory and normative institutional pressures, rather than purely by economic necessity (Berrone, Fosfuri, Gelabert, & Gomez-Mejia, 2013). This finding directly supports the framework's claim that governance-related structures emerge to signal legitimacy, not solely to optimize performance.

Surroca et al. (2010): Surroca et al. (2010) Surroca, Tribó, and Waddock (2010) primarily ground their argument in the resource-based view and stakeholder theory rather than institutional theory. Accordingly, this thesis treats their finding that the responsibility-performance link operates indirectly through intangible resources as a complementary, non-institutional explanation for why substantive (rather than symbolic) governance responses translate into firm-level outcomes. This is consistent with the secondary stakeholder-theory lens introduced in Section 2.1.

2.4 Propositions Guiding the Thematic Synthesis

Proposition 1: AI governance and sustainability governance represent two manifestations of the same institutional pressure toward organizational legitimacy, differing primarily in their degree of institutionalization.

Proposition 2: Symbolic and substantive conformity coexist in both AI governance and sustainability governance. Sustainability governance has more developed institutional mechanisms for distinguishing between them, whereas AI governance remains more vulnerable to symbolic conformity because its governance procedures and measurement standards are less established.

Proposition 3: As AI governance becomes further institutionalized, its practices may converge with established sustainability governance mechanisms, such as board-level oversight structures and standardized reporting.

3. Methodology

This thesis follows an integrative literature review (ILR) design, as outlined by Cronin and George (2020). Their framework treats the choice of review type not as a stylistic preference but as the outcome of a structured decision process, beginning with a single question: Is the goal of the review to settle a disputed empirical question (adjudication), or to open up new directions for a field by reframing how its existing knowledge is understood (redirection)? Cronin and George (2020) tie this distinction to similar logic found elsewhere in methods literature. Turner et al. (2017) on convergent versus holistic triangulation, and Edmondson and McManus (2007) on quantitative versus qualitative methods, both make the same point: the purpose of a review should determine the method, not the other way around.

Adjudication is the domain of meta-analysis and systematic review, and both require something this thesis's object of study does not have: a set of studies that test a comparable relationship using sufficiently similar constructs and methods that their results can be pooled or directly weighed against one another. AI corporate governance and sustainability corporate governance are not two competing answers to the same empirical question. They are two largely self-contained research programs, each with its own constructs, methods, and theoretical vocabulary. There is no shared dependent variable or causal claim across the majority of the two literatures that this thesis could adjudicate. Redirection is the most appropriate term in this case. The objective is not to determine the validity of the claims made by the two literatures, but rather to identify what becomes visible once they are read against each other.

Cronin and George (2020) argue that redirection works better with theory, narrative review, or integrative review than with adjudication-oriented tools like meta-analysis or systematic review. To choose between these three, they look at how much of the argument is already supported by existing studies, and how much the author has to add through their own reasoning. If the claim is well supported by existing studies, the work is considered as a review. If the author has to fill in gaps that the literature does not cover, the result is more of a theory. This thesis is based on claims that AI-governance and sustainability-governance scholars have already made in their published work, not on speculation about untested mechanisms. Therefore, it is evident that this aligns more closely with the review aspect. Developing an entirely new theory would not be the most suitable approach in this case.

The second criterion is scope: does the review stay within a single community of researchers, or does it compare across separate communities that study related questions in relative isolation from one another? Cronin and George (2020) use the term "community of practice" to describe groups of researchers who work on similar topics but differ in the paradigms, terminology, and research traditions they rely on. AI governance and sustainability governance scholarship plausibly fit this description. A preliminary scan of journals, keywords, and citation patterns carried out for this thesis suggests that the two fields publish in largely separate venues, use different core terminology, and rarely cite one another. However, confirming this more rigorously is itself part of what the search strategy in Sections 3.2-3.5 is designed to establish. A narrative review would not be suitable for this purpose, since Cronin and George reserve it for organizing what a single community already knows. An integrative review, in contrast, is built specifically to compare and connect what separate communities have found on their own

This thesis adopts the redirection-type ILR. The explicit goal is to bring AI governance research and sustainability/ESG governance research, currently parallel literatures with little connection between them, into a single comparative frame, rather than ranking or adjudicating between their respective findings.

3.1 Methodological Mechanics: Completeness, Balance, and Thematic Synthesis

Cronin and George's (2020) model of the ILR process is structured into two stages. The first stage is the assembly of the literature, governed by the standards of completeness and balance. The second stage is the synthesis of the literature into cross-community themes. Completeness in their account means finding the range of communities of practice studying a topic, which implies deliberately considering which other communities might be studying the same topic under different terminology. Cronin and George argue that achieving completeness requires deliberately searching into unfamiliar research communities and reconciling unfamiliar concepts and methodologies, rather than relying only on the terms and databases familiar to the author's own field. The search design of this thesis directly addresses this requirement by building separate keyword clusters for the AI-governance and sustainability-governance literatures. Instead of starting from one field's vocabulary and extending it loosely to the other, both clusters were searched using the same Boolean logic and inclusion criteria across Scopus and Web of Science.

Balance addresses the process of determining the significance of the gathered findings once they have been collected. Cronin and George (2020) warn that the number of citations or sheer number of studies can be mistaken for importance. They recommend that authors evaluate each community's findings based on its own standards rather than comparing one community's findings with another. This is a relevant caution for this thesis specifically because sustainability governance is the older and more extensively published of the two fields; without deliberate counterweight, it could potentially dominate the final sample simply by virtue of its size. The application of identical inclusion thresholds (FT50 status, followed by Q1/Scimago as a secondary filter) to both clusters independently serves as this thesis's pragmatic, procedural operationalization of the balance requirement. This standard has been chosen to ensure a level of transparency and replicability in the selection process, which is essential for the analysis of two unfamiliar literatures. It is important to note that this standard is more consistent than the fully qualitative, community-specific judgment described by Cronin and George.

Cronin and George describe synthesis as a process of moving from each community's individual findings, also known as lower-order elements, to broader categories that hold

across communities, also known as higher-order themes. Their process is explicitly described as a combination of abstraction and juxtaposition, rather than solely abstraction. This suggests that merely listing each community's themes side by side would not lead to true integration. Synthesis is integrative when connections between themes are made explicit. In this case, findings from separate communities are understood in relation to one another rather than simply listed in parallel. For this thesis, Section 3's synthesis will not only present AI-governance findings followed by sustainability-governance findings. Instead, it will organize each cluster around dominant themes and integrate cross-cutting patterns in a final synthesis section. These categories are accountability, legitimacy and stakeholder pressure, disclosure and transparency, and board-level oversight. These categories were selected because the underlying keyword clusters suggest related concepts recur across both fields, even where surface terminology differs. The validity of these categories, once the full sample is screened and synthesized, is discussed in Section 3. Durand, Hawn, and Ioannou's (2019) institutional framework is employed in this thesis as a potential organizing structure for those categories; this connection is the thesis's own theoretical choice and is not part of Cronin and George's framework itself.

Cronin and George (2020) observe that this process rarely progresses in a single iteration, characterizing it as an iterative process between the author and the reviewed literature that sometimes requires multiple cycles. As a result, the framework generally requires revisions as the review progresses. This thesis considers the current cluster structure and thematic categories as a preliminary basis for further refinement. This basis may be adjusted once full screening and synthesis reveal patterns not visible at the search-design stage.

3.2 Search Strategy and Keyword Selection

The Keywords were identified through an initial review of seminal articles from Financial Times Top 50 (FT50) journals covering artificial intelligence, corporate governance, sustainability governance, corporate social responsibility, and ESG practices. Recurring terms in article titles, abstracts, author keywords, and theoretical discussions were recorded and grouped into three thematic clusters: an AI governance cluster, a sustainability governance cluster, and an overlap cluster capturing the intersection of both fields.

For the database search itself, the keyword set was narrowed to the terms verified against the ten FT50 articles underlying the theoretical framework, so that the search remains grounded in established literature rather than in the broader.

Cluster A (AI Governance) focuses on 'artificial intelligence' combined with governance-related terms such as oversight, accountability, and disclosure, together with a set of AI-management phrases ('managing AI', 'AI management', 'AI feedback', 'AI disclosure', 'human-algorithm', 'human-AI collaboration'). Cluster B (Sustainability Governance) combines sustainability- and ESG-related terms ('carbon risk', 'legal origin', 'stakeholder orientation', 'corporate sustainability', 'corporate social responsibility', 'sustainab*') with governance-, board-, and disclosure-related qualifiers. Cluster C (Theoretical/Overlap) captures the shared theoretical vocabulary between the two fields, in particular Institutional Theory constructs ('issue salience', 'symbolic conformity', 'substantive conformity', 'institutional pressure*', 'legitimacy', 'normative pressure*', 'mimetic', 'coercive') combined with environmental-innovation and compliance-related terms.

Table 1 presents the keywords selected from the ten FT50 anchor articles.

Cluster	Authors (Year)	Journal	Keyword(s) Selected
AI Governance	Berente, N., Gu, B., Recker, J., & Santhanam, R. (2021)	MIS Quarterly	artificial intelligence; AI; governance; oversight; accountability; disclosure; managing AI, AI ethics
AI Governance	Tong, S., Jia, N., Luo, X., & Fang, Z. (2021)	Strategic Management Journal	AI disclosure; artificial intelligence; AI; accountability; AI feedback
AI Governance	Abbasi, A., Parsons, J., Pant, G., Liu Sheng, O. R., & Sarker, S. (2024)	Information Systems Research	artificial intelligence; AI; governance; human
AI Governance	Caro, F., Colliard, J.-E., Katok, E., Ockenfels, A., Stier-Moses, N., Tucker, C., & Wu, D. J. (2026)	Management Science	artificial intelligence; AI; AI governance; oversight; AI disclosure; Human-Algorithm; human-AI
Sustainability Governance	Eccles, R. G., Ioannou, I., & Serafeim, G. (2014)	Management Science	artificial intelligence; AI; AI governance; oversight; AI disclosure; Human-Algorithm; human-AI
Sustainability Governance	Liang, H., & Renneboog, L. (2017)	Journal of Finance	carbon risk; legal origin; stakeholder orientation; governance; investor; Corporate Social Responsibility; Legal origin; stakeholder orientation; CSR; Sustainability; firm value
Sustainability Governance	Bolton, P., & Kacperczyk, M. (2021)	Journal of Financial Economics	carbon risk; governance; disclosure; carbon emission; stock return; cost of capital; investor; premium; firm value
Theoretical Overlap	/ Durand, R., Hawn, O., & Ioannou, I. (2019)	Academy of Management Review	issue salience; symbolic conformity; normative pressures; substantive conformity; intangible resources; compliance;

			institutional theory; conformity; compliance; normative pressures; organizational; institutional pressure; environmental; regulatory; normative pressure;
Theoretical Overlap	/ Berrone, P., Fosfuri, A., Gelabert, L., & Gomez-Mejia, L. R. (2013)	Strategic Management Journal	institutional pressure; environmental innovation; institutional theory; compliance; normative pressures; legitimacy; normative pressure; coercive; green; conformity
Theoretical Overlap	/ Surroca, J., Tribó, J. A., & Waddock, S. (2010)	Strategic Management Journal	intangible resources.; legitimacy; organizational; pressure; innovation

Table 1. Keyword Selection from the Ten FT50 Anchor Articles

3.3 Databases and Search Procedure

The search was conducted in two databases, Scopus and Web of Science, selected for their broad and largely complementary coverage of business and management literature. The search was conducted from the start of June through July 2026. Both databases were searched using equivalent Boolean strings, adapted to each platform's syntax: Title-Abstract-Keywords search in Scopus, and Topic search (TS=) in Web of Science. Each cluster was searched independently using the keyword groups identified in the previous step, with synonyms within a cluster combined using the Boolean operator OR. For terms that proved too broad on their own (e.g., “Accountability,” “Corporate social responsibility”), an additional AND condition was introduced linking the term to its governing domain (artificial intelligence or governance, respectively) since on their own these terms returned far too many irrelevant records.¹

3.4 Filtering Criteria

Following the keyword search, results were filtered by document type (journal articles only) and language (English) in both databases, together with a single subject-area restriction.

¹ Two databases were used instead of one because Scopus and Web of Science don't have identical journal coverage, and searching only one risks missing relevant work. This matters especially for an interdisciplinary topic like this one, where subject-area filters can exclude relevant work that falls outside a single database's core categories.

Business, Management and Accounting in Scopus, and the equivalent Management, Business, and Business Finance categories in Web of Science.

As a secondary quality filter, journals were cross-checked against the current SCImago Q1 ranking, in addition to the FT50 list used to identify the seminal articles underlying the keyword selection and theoretical framework.

3.5 Sample Size and Screening

Applying the search strings built from the keyword clusters described in Section 3.2, through the database procedure set out in Section 3.3, produced 14,536 records in total: 7,881 from Scopus (Cluster A - AI Governance: 2,410; Cluster B - Sustainability Governance: 2,374; Cluster C - Theoretical/Overlap: 3,097) and 6,655 from Web of Science (Cluster A: 1,716; Cluster B: 2,621; Cluster C: 2,318). All 14,536 records were imported into Rayyan, a web-based systematic review platform, for duplicate detection and removal. Rayyan was subsequently used to manage the title and abstract screening process and to document the inclusion and exclusion decisions for each record.

Following the quality-filtering approach outlined in Section 3.4, the 10,418 unique records were then checked against SCImago Q1 status (Business, Management and Accounting subject area) or FT50 listing. This left 5,535 records for title/abstract screening; the remaining 4,883 records did not meet either criterion and were excluded. The remaining 5,535 records were screened manually at title/abstract level against the eligibility criteria. Each record was read and judged on topical fit, whether it addressed governance at the firm level (as opposed to state- or regulatory-level governance), whether it engaged substantively with AI governance or sustainability governance constructs (as opposed to purely technical AI/ML methodology, or an individual/user-level behavioral focus), and whether the context was transferable to general corporate governance rather than tied to a specific, non-transferable domain such as healthcare, education or public administration. Records with no genuine topical relevance to either field were excluded on the same pass. The overall effect of this stage was to reduce the 5,535 screened records to the final sample of 93 articles used for the thematic synthesis in Chapter 4.

3.6 Search Results

Table 2 reports the number of records retrieved for each of the three keyword clusters, in both databases. These records were retrieved after the Business/Management/Accounting (Scopus) or Management/Business/Business Finance (Web of Science) subject-area restriction described in Section 3.4.

Cluster	Scopus (n)	Web of Science (n)	Combined (n)
A - AI Governance	2,410	1,716	4,126
B - Sustainability Governance	2,374	2,621	4,995
C - Theoretical/Overlap	3,097	2,318	5,415
Total	7,881	6,655	14,536

Table 2. Records by Cluster and Database

Table 2 shows that the Theoretical/Overlap cluster produced the largest number of records, with 5,415 results, followed by Sustainability Governance with 4,995 and AI Governance with 4,126. Scopus returned more records for AI Governance than Web of Science (2,410 compared with 1,716) and also more records for the Theoretical/Overlap cluster (3,097 compared with 2,318). Web of Science, by contrast, returned slightly more Sustainability Governance records than Scopus (2,621 compared with 2,374). Overall, Scopus contributed 7,881 records and Web of Science contributed 6,655, resulting in 14,536 records before duplicate removal and screening. These figures describe the output of the search strategy and should not be interpreted as direct measures of the size of the underlying literatures, because the clusters were defined using different keyword combinations. Figure 1 summarizes the subsequent identification, screening, and inclusion process outlined in Section 3.5.

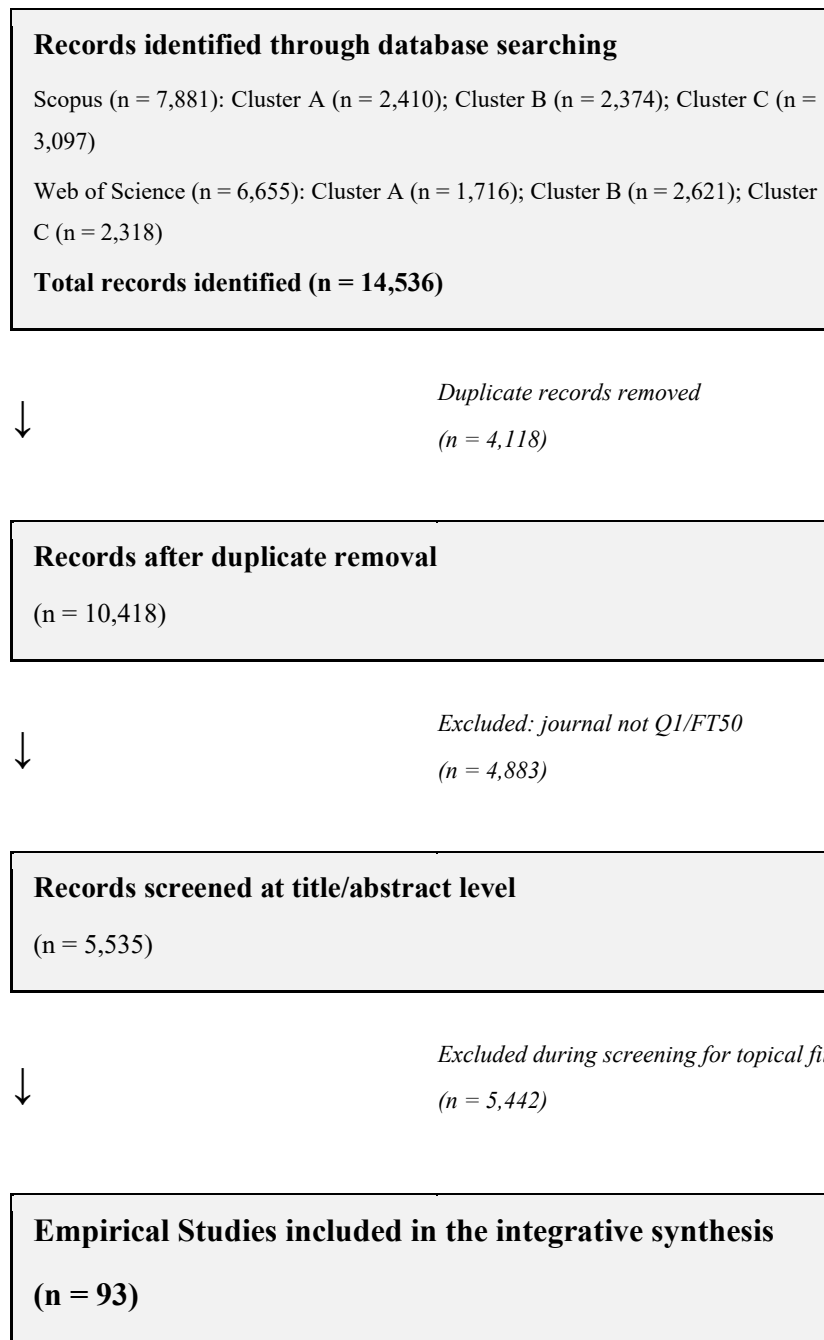


Figure 1. PRISMA-style flow diagram of the search, screening and inclusion process.

The screening process reduced the initial 14,536 records to 93 studies included in the final integrative synthesis. The substantial reduction reflects the application of duplicate removal, journal-quality filters, and manual relevance screening. Table 3 summarizes the full search and screening funnel, from the initial database records through to the final set of included studies.

Stage	Records (n)
Records identified through database searching (Scopus + WoS, 3 clusters)	14,536
Duplicate records removed	4,118
Records after duplicate removal	10,418
Excluded: journal not Q1/FT50	4,883
Records screened at title/abstract level	5,535
Excluded during manual title/abstract screening	5,442
Studies included in the integrative synthesis	93

Table 3. Search Results Summary

It shows how the initial search was narrowed to the final empirical sample. The database search identified 14,536 records across Scopus and Web of Science. After 4,118 duplicate records were removed, 10,418 records remained. The Q1/FT50 journal restriction excluded a further 4,883 records, leaving 5,535 records for title and abstract screening. Manual screening then excluded 5,442 records, resulting in 93 studies included in the integrative synthesis. This screening process transformed a broad initial search into a focused empirical sample for the thematic analysis.

The full extraction table documenting all 93 included articles (title, authors, year, journal, abstract, research questions, theory, methodology, sample, findings, and implications) is available at:

[Table-for-findings-ILR_93_articles.xlsx](#)

The review therefore draws on two distinct source groups: 93 empirical studies and ten FT50 anchor articles. The 93 studies constitute the empirical sample, while the ten FT50 articles provide the theoretical framework and guide the interpretation of the thematic synthesis. The anchor articles are reported separately and are not counted among the 93 empirical studies.

Initial descriptive analysis is conducted to examine the sample of the selected articles. Figure 2 presents the distribution of sample articles by research method. Figure 3 displays the distribution of sample articles by primary theoretical lens. Figure 4 explains the distribution

of sample articles by publication year. Finally, Table 4 provides a synthesis of the research gaps and future research directions by cluster.

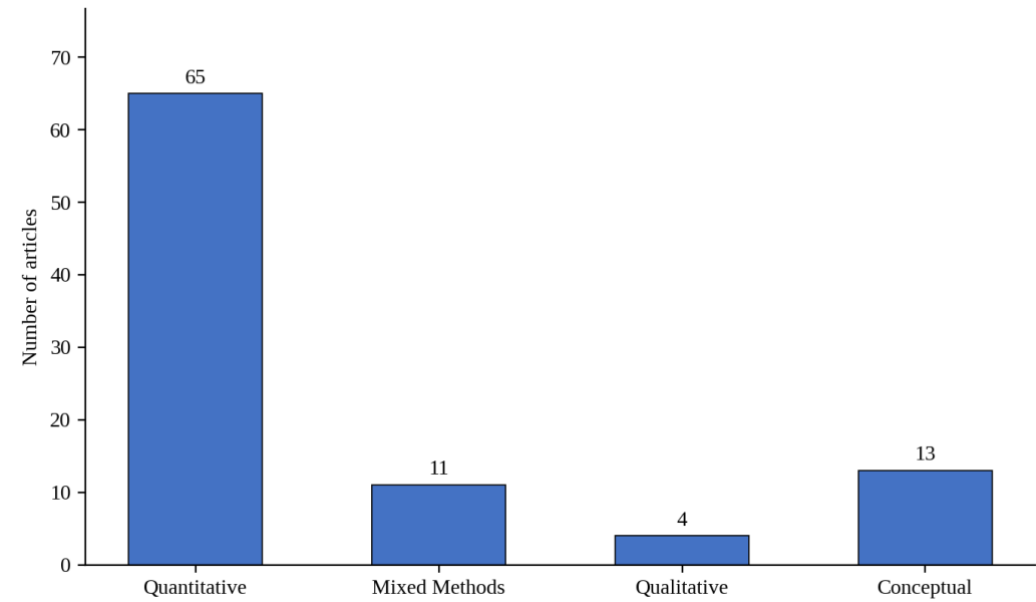


Figure 2. Distribution of Sample Articles by Research Method

The sample is dominated by quantitative studies (n=65, 70%), predominantly panel-regression designs using archival data. Mixed-methods (n=11) and purely qualitative studies (n=4) are comparatively rare, and 13 articles are conceptual, review-based, or design-science contributions without primary data collection. The distribution indicates that quantitative designs dominate the reviewed literature across both fields, while qualitative and process-oriented research on how organizations implement governance mechanisms in practice remains comparatively underexplored.

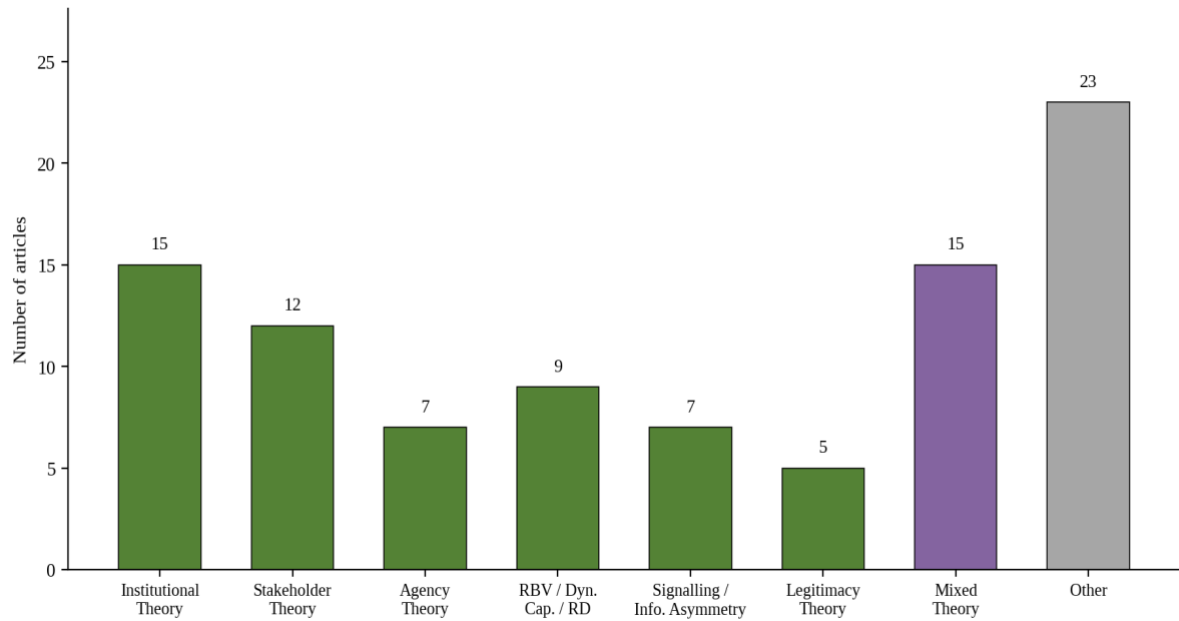


Figure 3. Distribution of Sample Articles by Primary Theoretical Lens²

Institutional theory is the most frequently identified single framework (n=15), consistent with its use as the organizing lens for this thesis, followed by stakeholder theory (n=12). A substantial share of articles (n=23) draw on a theory outside the six coded categories or state no formal theoretical framework at all, and a further 15 articles explicitly combine multiple theories as joint, equally weighted lenses. Taken together, this suggests the AI-sustainability governance literature is still theoretically fragmented, with no single dominant paradigm comparable to, for example, agency theory's role in mainstream corporate governance research.

² Note: articles whose hypotheses or theoretical contribution rest clearly on one theory were coded to that theory, following a four-step hierarchy: the theory explicitly named as the study's framework, the theory underlying the hypothesized relationships, the theory underlying the stated theoretical contribution, and, where still unclear, the theory with the greatest analytical role in the findings. Articles that explicitly combine two or more theories as joint, equally weighted lenses (e.g., "twin lenses" framings) with no stated primary were coded as "Mixed Theory" instead of being forced into a single category; the specific combination for each is documented in the classification review file. "Other" covers articles whose named theory falls outside the seven coded categories, or where no theoretical framework is named at all.

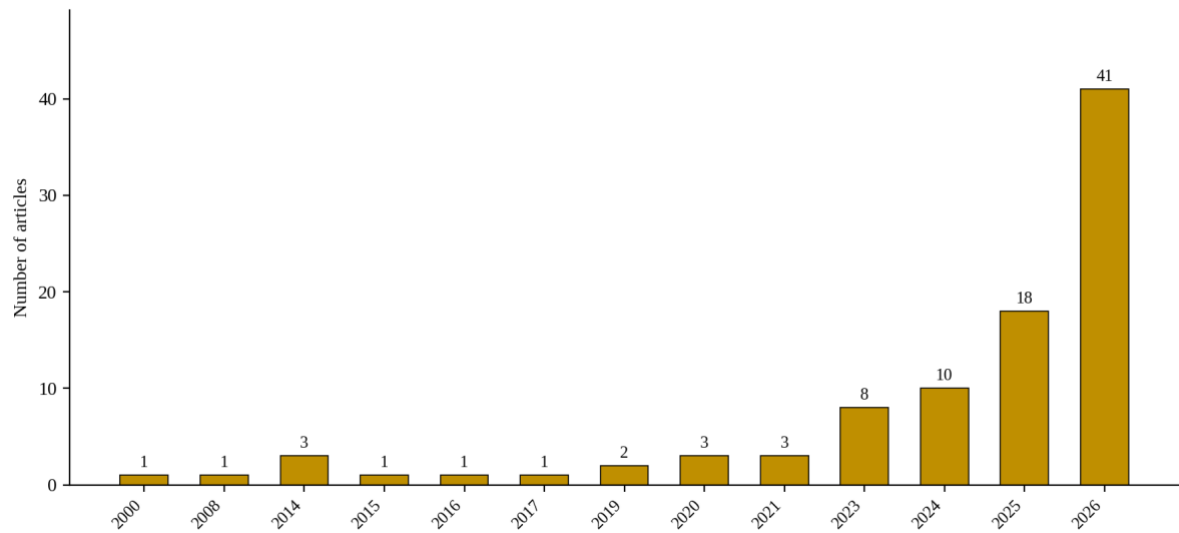


Figure 4. Distribution of Sample Articles by Publication Year

Publications are heavily concentrated in the most recent years: 41 of the 93 articles (44%) were published in 2026 alone, and 59 articles (63%) appeared in 2025 or 2026. This distribution reflects the recency of AI governance as a research topic rather than a search bias, since the keyword strategy applied no date restriction. The pattern indicates that comparative work on AI and sustainability governance is only now beginning to emerge, which reinforces the timeliness and relevance of this review.

Cluster	Synthesized Research Gap	Suggested Future Research Direction	Representative articles from the reviewed sample
AI Governance	Institutionalization and reporting. Most AI-governance frameworks in the reviewed sample stop at the principle level. Emmett et al. structure their framework around five domains, covering strategic control, data and compliance, operations and technology, the human and ethical side, and accountability. Papagiannidis et al. identify seven responsible-AI principles but note that organizations struggle to turn them into practice, and Skeja & Sadiku-Dushi sketch decision rights and escalation paths that remain proposals rather than established practice. Standardized reporting and disclosure conventions are not yet consistently applied across the reviewed articles either. Bonsón et al. find that 41.5% of firms report no AI activity at all, meaning only 58.5% disclose any AI activity.	Rather than adding another competing multi-domain framework, future work could test whether firms that adopt principle-level commitments (transparency, accountability) actually build the organizational structures Emmett et al. and Skeja & Sadiku-Dushi describe, or whether the gap between principle and practice persists regardless.	Emmett et al. (2026); Papagiannidis et al. (2025); Skeja & Sadiku-Dushi (2026); Bonsón et al. (2021)
	Nonlinear adoption effects. The limited evidence on AI adoption and firm outcomes in the reviewed sample is mixed and suggests the relationship may be nonlinear rather than uniformly positive. Khalid et al. report a U-shaped association between AI adoption and financial misconduct. Bergougui et al. find that AI's effect on greenwashing depends on environmental regulation and technological context rather than adoption levels alone, with AI reducing greenwashing most clearly under moderate regulation, while the effect can shift under weak or very strict regulatory regimes. Within the reviewed sample, evidence on the interaction between AI exposure, board composition, and firm risk also remains limited (Hudson & Morgan), where the interaction term is associated with increased rather than decreased risk in AI-intensive firms. Given how few studies these patterns rest on, they should be read as preliminary rather than established.	These threshold associations need testing across a wider range of adoption intensities, firm types, and governance contexts before the tipping points can be considered reliable. Replication across industries, countries, and different board structures is needed before the AI exposure, board composition, and risk interaction can be generalized.	Khalid et al. (2025); Bergougui et al. (2026); Hudson & Morgan (2026)

Cluster	Synthesized Research Gap	Suggested Future Research Direction	Representative articles from the reviewed sample
Sustainability Governance	ESG measurement and rating disagreement. Within the reviewed literature, ESG scores are frequently used as outcome or explanatory variables, while the construction of these scores and the sources of disagreement between rating agencies receive comparatively less systematic attention. Drempetic et al. show how firm size and data availability can shape ESG scores, whereas Kurbus & Rant highlight the role of legal origins in explaining disagreement between rating agencies.	There is room for comparative work on rating methodology and agency transparency, for tracking how new regulation such as CSRD changes rating disagreement over time, and for connecting legal-origin theory more directly to the question of measurement-level divergence specifically.	Drempetic et al. (2020); Kurbus & Rant (2025)
	Conditional effectiveness of governance mechanisms. Sustainability-governance mechanisms (carbon disclosure, institutional ownership pressure, board committees, regulation) are present in the reviewed sample, but their effectiveness varies by context rather than holding uniformly. Jiang et al. find disclosure can be largely symbolic in high-carbon sectors while functioning as genuine governance in low-carbon ones. Adamolekun et al. show that emissions-trading-scheme membership does not necessarily indicate more substantive climate governance. Peters & Romi find that different governance mechanisms affect different outcomes: environmental committees mainly raise the likelihood that a firm discloses at all, sustainability officers and subject-matter expertise relate more closely to how transparent that disclosure is, and larger committees are sometimes associated with lower transparency. The mechanisms exist; what the sample doesn't yet clarify is when they function substantively versus symbolically.	A useful next step is identifying the boundary conditions (sector, ownership type, regulatory timing, committee expertise versus committee size) that determine whether a given mechanism ends up symbolic or substantive, and then examining whether AI-governance mechanisms diverge the same way as that field matures.	Jiang et al. (2023); Azar et al. (2021); Adamolekun et al. (2025); Peters & Romi (2014); Aboud et al. (2024); Issa (2024)

Cluster	Synthesized Research Gap	Suggested Future Research Direction	Representative articles from the reviewed sample
AI–Sustainability Interface	Organizational mechanisms. Several articles in the reviewed sample still treat AI as a technical fix rather than something embedded in people and organizational structure. Wang, Feng & Shen are a partial exception: they find human-AI collaboration supports low-carbon transformation overall, and this effect is stronger where executives bring relevant environmental background and where the firm has high absorptive capacity. Colapinto et al. apply an audit framework, while Skeja & Sadiku-Dushi propose a conceptual CARE framework; both point toward audit and oversight structures that could bridge AI and sustainability governance, though neither yet demonstrates those structures operating as routine organizational practice.	Mixed-methods work, pairing survey or case-study data with the kind of secondary data used in this sample, could clarify how human-AI collaboration plays out in practice, and testing mediating mechanisms such as financing constraints or green-technology innovation across different regulatory settings would show whether the Wang, Feng & Shen pattern holds more generally.	Wang, Feng & Shen (2025); Colapinto et al. (2026); Skeja & Sadiku-Dushi (2026)
	Substantive versus symbolic AI-enabled sustainability. Even where AI and sustainability are studied together in the reviewed sample, using AI does not clearly indicate better sustainability performance. Yadav & Asongu find AI adoption is associated with more greenwashing, while verified ESG performance moves in the opposite direction. The negative association between verified ESG performance and greenwashing becomes stronger under stricter regulation. Song et al. add a further complication: AI-policy adoption improves ESG performance most among firms and regions that started out digitally behind, not the ones typically expected to benefit most.	What the sample suggests is needed is a way to measure AI-related sustainability performance that does not treat adoption itself as a stand-in for genuine improvement, along with testing whether Song et al.'s catching-up pattern holds outside the specific regions and digital-maturity levels they studied.	Yadav & Asongu (2026); Song et al. (2025)

Table 4. Synthesized Research Gaps and Future Research Directions by Cluster³

³Note: Table 4 groups the 93 articles into three broader clusters (AI Governance, Sustainability Governance, AI–Sustainability Interface) with six synthesized gap sub-themes, a classification used specifically to structure this research-gap synthesis. This differs from the five-theme classification used in Chapter 4 (Section 4), which assigns each article to the theme reflecting its main empirical contribution. The two classifications serve different purposes and are not intended to align one-to-one.

4. Thematic Synthesis

The review includes 93 studies. The chapter also draws on ten FT50 anchor articles, which are used as theoretical and interpretive foundations but are not included in the empirical count of 93 studies. Five themes were developed inductively from recurring patterns in the findings recorded in the Excel table. Each article was assigned to the theme that best reflected its main contribution. The themes are presented in conceptual order, moving from AI adoption and firm-level outcomes to ESG performance and scores, AI disclosure and oversight, carbon and governance mechanisms, and finally, board composition and diversity. The number of articles assigned to each theme is reported descriptively.

The five themes are:

- Theme 1: AI Adoption and Firm-Level Outcomes (n=23)
- Theme 2: ESG Performance and Scores (n=13)
- Theme 3: AI Disclosure, Transparency and Oversight (n=17)
- Theme 4: Carbon and Governance Mechanisms (n=28)
- Theme 5: Board Composition and Diversity (n=12)

a. Clustering Approach

The themes were developed from the information recorded in the Excel review table. Recurring topics, governance mechanisms, and outcomes were compared across the findings of the 93 studies. Studies were then grouped when they addressed a similar mechanism or outcome, for example AI adoption, disclosure, board composition, carbon governance, or ESG performance. The preliminary groups were compared across the research questions, theories, and findings. Overlapping groups were then merged, and each article was assigned to the theme that best reflected its main contribution. Finally, the allocation was checked against the full table so that each study appeared once and the five theme counts added up to 93. The result is an inductive grouping based on the content of the reviewed studies rather

than on categories defined in advance, consistent with the integrative review approach outlined by Cronin and George (2020).

b. AI Adoption and Firm-Level Governance Outcomes

The first theme examines recurring findings on the relationship between AI adoption and firm-level governance outcomes. The theme also includes a number of studies centred on innovation and financial-performance outcomes rather than governance specifically; the discussion below focuses on the subset of findings most directly relevant to governance, consistent with the comparative aim of this review. The findings indicate that AI adoption is associated with changes in firm-level performance, internal control, and environmental and social governance outcomes. At first sight, the findings seem to point in one direction. Giordino et al. (2026) find that organizational AI focus is positively associated with environmental and social performance and with financial performance, while its relationship with the governance pillar is positive but statistically insignificant.

Khalid et al. (2025) also report a positive governance-related effect, but in a different outcome area: AI adoption reduces financial misconduct through reduced managerial myopia and stronger internal controls. The negative effect on misconduct is significant at moderate levels of AI adoption, but the benefit diminishes at high levels of adoption, producing a U-shaped relationship rather than a simple linear one.

This qualification matters because it changes how the results should be interpreted. The reviewed evidence does not support a simple technology-performance relationship in which more AI automatically produces better results. The effects depend on what AI is used for and on the organizational conditions around it. The positive association with environmental and social performance does not extend automatically to the governance pillar, and the reduction in misconduct does not continue indefinitely as adoption increases. The benefits are therefore conditional rather than inherent in the technology itself.

Adobor (2026) helps explain why these limits appear. The study links AI failures to premature problem closure, over-trust in algorithms, hype, displaced managerial judgement, and bias amplification. It also emphasises governance-in-use practices as a way of limiting these problems. This shifts the interpretation away from the question of whether AI is good or bad for firms. The more relevant question is *how firms decide when to trust an AI system, who can challenge its output, and what happens when the system performs badly*. These

questions are still less visible in the adoption literature than the performance outcomes themselves.

The sustainability findings make this tension particularly clear. Dimes et al. (2026) show in an experiment that ChatGPT-generated sustainability reports contain more greenwashing indicators than real reports. The mean Cheap Talk Index is 16.2 for the AI-generated reports and 7.3 for the real reports. Participants nevertheless rated the AI-generated reports as more optimistic, confident, and trustworthy.

Bergougui et al. (2026) report a different pattern. AI language-model adoption is associated with lower ESG greenwashing overall, but the relationship is nonlinear across regulatory and green-technology regimes: in the moderate-regulation regime the coefficient changes sign, and AI becomes associated with lower greenwashing, rather than the effect simply strengthening after a single regulatory threshold.

The two findings are not contradictory once the object of analysis is considered. Dimes et al. (2026) examine how generative AI can shape the content and reception of sustainability reports. Bergougui et al. (2026) examine AI adoption as a firm-level mechanism associated with greenwashing outcomes under different institutional conditions. What the cluster shows is not that *AI has one stable sustainability effect, but that its effect changes with the application, the organizational setting, and the surrounding regulatory environment.*

Most studies in this cluster examine AI adoption, AI focus, or firm performance rather than AI governance directly, so their bearing on Proposition 1 is indirect: they show AI already linked to environmental performance, disclosure, and internal control, which is evidence of an institutionalization gap rather than a complete separation between the fields, but not evidence about governance structures themselves. For Proposition 2, the evidence is mixed: AI can support substantive improvements, but it can also make symbolic communication more convincing. The main result of this cluster is therefore conditionality. AI adoption creates opportunities, but it does not remove the need for governance. In some cases, it creates additional reasons for governance.

c. ESG Performance and Scores

The ESG-score literature raises a recurring problem: the quality of the measurement itself. This theme also includes a number of studies centred on how AI drives ESG performance more generally, rather than on measurement or governance specifically; the discussion below focuses on the subset of findings that speak most directly to institutional infrastructure and measurement, consistent with the comparative aim of this review. Kurbus and Rant (2025) find different levels of disagreement between rating providers across civil-law and common-law settings. Civil-law firms show higher inter-provider correlations but also greater dispersion disagreement. The scores capture different judgments depending on the institutional setting and the rating dimension, rather than measuring a single underlying quality that is simply good or bad.

If rating agencies disagree more about civil-law firms even while correlating more highly on average, the underlying construct of "ESG performance" may not be as stable as the maturity claims made about sustainability governance in Chapter 2 and Section 4.2 suggest. A field can have extensive measurement infrastructure, in the sense of many raters, long histories, and large datasets, without that infrastructure converging on a shared definition of what is being measured. Institutional depth is not the same as measurement validity, and this cluster is where that distinction matters most.

Drempetic et al. (2020) show that firm size, data availability, and reporting resources increase ESG scores. Larger firms do not consistently have lower greenhouse-gas intensity, which suggests that part of the size effect reflects greater capacity to disclose rather than better environmental performance. This finding matters for the comparison with AI, but it also raises a question the study itself cannot fully resolve: whether large firms score higher because disclosure capacity inflates their ratings, or because large firms operate in less emissions-intensive sectors to begin with. The findings are consistent with the interpretation that disclosure capacity contributes to higher ESG scores, although the observational design cannot rule out the alternative. Sustainability governance has established metrics, but established metrics are not automatically neutral or comparable, and a discipline that has not settled this question after several decades of ESG rating practice should not be treated as a straightforward benchmark for a younger field like AI governance to imitate.

The AI findings complicate the picture further, and not always in a consistent direction. Yadav and Asongu (2026) find that AI adoption is positively associated with greenwashing,

whereas verified ESG performance is negatively associated with it; the negative relationship between verified performance and greenwashing becomes stronger under higher regulatory stringency. Song et al. (2025), by contrast, report that AI policy adoption improves ESG performance more strongly in regions with a weak digital economy and among firms with weak digital-transformation foundations. Read together, these two findings sit in some tension: one treats AI adoption as a channel for greenwashing, the other treats AI policy adoption as a genuine performance driver, particularly where digital capacity is otherwise weak. The tension is plausibly reconcilable, adoption of AI tools by individual firms may differ in effect from AI policy adoption at the regional level, but neither study is designed to test that distinction directly, and the cluster as a whole does not yet offer a reconciled account of when AI helps sustainability performance and when it merely helps sustainability reporting. The presence of AI does not, on this evidence, tell us whether sustainability performance is genuine.

The Yadav, Asongu, and Song et al. (2026) findings speak to AI adoption and ESG performance rather than to AI governance structures directly, so their support for Proposition 1 is indirect: this cluster supports the proposition by showing that sustainability governance has a measurement infrastructure that AI-related practice largely lacks. It also complicates Proposition 1 in a way the earlier themes do not: an infrastructure that generates disagreement among its own experts is institutionalised mainly in form, without being obviously more institutionalised in a meaningful sense than a field with no infrastructure at all. The cluster qualifies Proposition 2 because even established ESG metrics can coexist with selective disclosure and greenwashing, symbolic conformity survives contact with sophisticated measurement systems, it does not disappear once metrics exist. For Proposition 3, the implication is practical and somewhat deflationary: AI governance cannot converge with sustainability governance simply by adopting the language and apparatus of ESG measurement, since that apparatus has not resolved its own validity problems. It would also need credible, contested-but-improving measures of AI-related risk, responsibility, and performance, and this cluster suggests that borrowing sustainability governance's measurement model wholesale could import its unresolved problems along with its legitimacy.

d. AI Disclosure, Transparency and Ethics/Oversight

The AI disclosure studies show another recurring pattern: *AI is becoming more visible in corporate reporting, but responsible-AI disclosure is not yet routine*. Bonsón et al. (2021) find that 24% of firms disclose no information on AI and a further 17.5% provide only general statements, together the 41.5% with the weakest disclosure; by contrast, 58.5% report some form of AI disclosure, and fewer than 5% disclose ethical principles. The headline figure of 58.5% is easy to read optimistically, but it should be read cautiously. A firm counted in that 58.5% may have done no more than mention AI in a strategy statement, and the finding that disclosure of ethical principles sits below 5% suggests that most of what counts as AI disclosure is closer to general corporate narrative than to governance-relevant information. Presence of disclosure and substance of disclosure are not the same thing, and this cluster repeatedly runs into that distinction without fully resolving it.

Juma'h (2026) finds that firm size, intangible intensity, and R&D intensity predict AI disclosure. At the same time, the quality of disclosure varies substantially: some firms provide transparent, standards-aligned information, while others rely on vague promotional language described as AI-washing. Elsayed (2025) identifies a shift from defensive to assertive disclosure after a period of crisis. More disclosure over time therefore does not necessarily mean better disclosure; it may instead reflect a change in how firms choose to present AI to external audiences once the immediate reputational threat has passed. Taken together, these two studies imply that disclosure volume is a poor proxy for disclosure quality, and any future AI-governance metric that simply counts mentions of AI, rather than distinguishing verifiable claims from promotional language, would likely reproduce the same measurement weaknesses already identified for ESG scores in Section 4.3.

The framework literature adds language and categories, but not yet a settled governance standard. Emmett et al. (2026) develop a five-domain GenAI governance framework containing 69 control considerations that address strategic, control, data, legal, technological, ethical, ESG, transparency, and technological-evolution risks; Papagiannidis et al. (2025) identify seven responsible-AI principles and explicitly point to a gap between principles and practical implementation. Both contributions are conceptual rather than evaluative: neither study demonstrates that firms adopting these frameworks actually behave differently from firms that do not. This literature already has a considerable supply of ethical language; what it lacks is a demonstrated route for translating that language into

organizational procedures, and evidence connecting framework adoption to measurable governance outcomes.

Skeja and Sadiku-Dushi (2026) describe accountability gaps and propose decision rights, escalation paths, refusal thresholds, and recertification triggers. These proposals matter because they make oversight more concrete than a values statement does, but they remain proposals rather than documented practice; the paper does not report firms that have implemented this architecture, only firms that plausibly need it. Section 4.5 shows what a routine version of this kind of responsibility looks like once a field has settled it: environmental committees with defined size, meeting frequency, and audit-committee overlap. In the AI literature, decision rights and escalation paths are still being defined and justified, not yet observed in comparably routine operation.

Auditing offers one possible connection to sustainability governance, though again the evidence is closer to promise than to demonstrated practice. Colapinto et al. (2026) present a framework for prioritising ESG trade-offs and allocating audit resources; Islam et al. (2026) find that AI-enabled auditing improves sustainability disclosure and that governance and digital compliance culture strengthen this relationship. Of the studies in this cluster, the Islam et al. (2026) result comes closest to an empirical test, since it links AI to a governance outcome rather than only proposing that such a link should exist, though even this is one study in one context. It is a narrow base from which to conclude that AI auditing has become a standard governance practice, and the finding's dependence on governance and compliance culture suggests the effect is conditional on organizational maturity that many firms will not yet have.

This cluster provides the clearest evidence for Proposition 2, and it does so unusually directly: AI disclosure can be informative, but it can also be promotional, and the same firms and the same disclosures cannot always be sorted cleanly into one category or the other. Ethical principles can guide practice, but their presence does not prove implementation, a distinction the reviewed studies raise but do not resolve. The gap between what firms say and what they are able to demonstrate remains central to the AI governance literature, and closing it will require the kind of independent verification that sustainability disclosure has only partially achieved for itself.

e. Carbon and Governance-Sustainability Mechanisms

The carbon studies provide the clearest evidence that the same governance instrument can have different functions in different settings. Jiang et al. (2023) find that firms with poor carbon performance disclose more, and that disclosure is negatively associated with subsequent carbon performance overall. In low-carbon sectors, the relationship changes: disclosure is positively associated with later performance. The study also shows that firms select between harder and softer forms of carbon information.

This result makes it difficult to treat disclosure as evidence of governance by itself. More disclosure can signal that a firm is responding to a problem, but it can also reflect the need to manage that problem rhetorically. In high-carbon settings, disclosure may be a response to legitimacy pressure. In low-carbon settings, it is more likely to be connected to subsequent performance improvements. The value of disclosure therefore depends on the relationship between what the firm reports and what it actually changes.

Investors provide a second form of pressure. Azar et al. (2021) report a negative association between Big Three ownership and emissions among MSCI firms. The effect is driven mainly by BlackRock and State Street and becomes stronger in later years. This is a more substantive governance mechanism than disclosure alone because ownership can affect managerial decisions directly. Even here, however, the effect is conditional on the investor, the level of ownership, and the time period examined.

Adamolekun et al. (2025) provide an important counterpoint. Membership in emission trading schemes increases climate risk, particularly in carbon-intensive industries. The relationship becomes significant after the Paris Agreement and persists for several years after entry. The finding does not show that the schemes have no value. It shows that formal participation should not be treated as proof of effective climate governance. Institutional membership can coexist with outcomes that move in the opposite direction from the stated purpose of the scheme.

Wang et al. (2025) add a different type of condition. Human-AI collaboration improves low-carbon transformation performance, but the effect is strengthened by executives' environmental background and absorptive capacity. It is weakened by supply-chain concentration and is stronger when technological uncertainty is lower and firms are larger. The result places organizational capabilities at the centre of the AI and sustainability

relationship. The technology matters, but it does not work independently of the people and structures that use it.

The broader governance studies show that sustainability is not embedded equally across firms. Aras and Crowther (2008) report that many FTSE100 firms did not connect governance with wider corporate activity, while only a small minority linked governance to all sustainability dimensions. This finding is important because it prevents the sustainability field from being treated as uniformly mature. Sustainability governance is more established than AI governance in several respects, but substantive integration remains uneven.

Regulation appears to be one factor that can change this situation. Issa (2024) finds that the relationship between environmental responsibility investment and financial performance becomes significant after the Paris Agreement. Aboud et al. (2024) report that both the 2014 passage and the 2017 mandate reduce ESG decoupling. The effects are weaker among firms with independently audited ESG information. Regulation therefore appears to create pressure for change, but it does not guarantee that every firm responds substantively.

Peters and Romi (2014) show how specific internal mechanisms affect environmental disclosure. Environmental committees and CSOs increase the likelihood of GHG disclosure. The likelihood also rises with committee size, meeting frequency, member expertise, and audit-committee overlap. For transparency, however, expertise is more important than committee size, and larger committees can be associated with lower transparency. This is a useful distinction. A firm may have the formal structure needed to disclose information without having the expertise needed to make that disclosure transparent.

This cluster provides the strongest basis for comparing institutional maturity. Sustainability governance has more developed mechanisms for ownership pressure, carbon disclosure, committees, and regulation. At the same time, the findings show that these mechanisms remain imperfect. They can be selective, poorly integrated, or disconnected from actual performance. Sustainability governance is therefore a point of comparison for AI governance, but not a model that can simply be copied without qualification.

f. Board Composition and Diversity

Board research produces a more focused pattern than the other clusters. Within the reviewed board-governance studies, gender diversity is the most frequently examined board characteristic and is generally positively associated with CSR, reporting, and environmental outcomes, as shown in the review by Velte (2023). Sustainability board expertise and sustainability-linked pay are also mainly positive, although the evidence is more heterogeneous. Unlike the disagreement documented in Section 4.3 or the promotional gap documented in Section 4.4, gender diversity is among the more consistent findings in the reviewed literature, holding up across a broad review rather than a single study, so the exceptions discussed below deserve attention rather than dismissal as noise.

The result should not be read as proof that gender diversity alone causes better sustainability performance, and the studies in this cluster acknowledge that limitation without fully escaping it. The studies identify an association, and the surrounding governance arrangements differ between firms in ways that are hard to fully control for: firms that appoint more diverse boards may also be firms with more progressive governance cultures generally, and separating the specific contribution of board composition from that broader disposition is not something a correlational design can settle. Board size and committee structures can have different effects on economic, environmental, and social outcomes, as shown by Cancela et al. (2020), which reinforces that the board operates as several distinct governance mechanisms rather than one uniform one. Its effect depends on which characteristic is examined and which outcome is measured, and the evidence here is considerably more conditional than a one-line summary such as "board diversity improves sustainability" would suggest.

The comparison with AI is where this cluster earns its place in the review, because AI-related board research is limited but not absent, and the two available studies pull in different directions. Elsayed and Ahmed (2025) find that board size and gender diversity are positively associated with AI disclosure in Egyptian banks, a result that echoes the sustainability-governance pattern closely enough to be encouraging, but it comes from a single national banking sector and has not been tested elsewhere; there is no way to tell from one study whether it reflects a general governance mechanism or something specific to that regulatory environment. Hudson and Morgan (2026) complicate the picture further: AI exposure and board-network heterogeneity each reduce idiosyncratic risk on their own, but

the interaction between them can increase risk in highly AI-intensive firms. That result is untidy rather than clean, and it matters for this thesis's argument for exactly that reason. It shows that governance mechanisms which are protective in isolation can combine to raise risk under specific technological conditions, a possibility that a straightforward transfer of sustainability-governance board practices to AI governance would not anticipate.

Taken on their own, neither study is enough to establish a common model of AI board oversight. Taken together with the sustainability findings above, they do at least correct an overstatement: AI board-composition research is thin rather than virtually non-existent, as an earlier draft of this synthesis assumed: it is concentrated in one banking sector and one risk-interaction result, and neither finding has been replicated. Sustainability governance has had considerably longer to examine board characteristics across countries and outcome measures, per the review by Velte (2023) discussed above, which is part of why its findings, gender diversity aside, are still more conditional than a maturity narrative would imply. AI governance research, starting from a much smaller base, deserves at least the same caution, not less.

This cluster suggests that convergence may occur through the transfer of familiar governance mechanisms, such as board diversity, expertise, and oversight, and the Elsayed and Ahmed result is consistent with that possibility. The Hudson and Morgan interaction effect argues against assuming the transfer will be automatic: a mechanism that reduces risk in the sustainability domain is not guaranteed to keep doing so once combined with algorithmic risk. The comparison is useful for exactly that reason, it exposes a shared vocabulary sitting on top of different empirical mechanics, and that gap matters more here than in the other four clusters, since board oversight is the mechanism most often proposed as the natural bridge between the two governance paradigms.

g. Discussion of the Propositions

Proposition 1: Institutional Asymmetry

The reviewed literature indicates an institutionalization gap between sustainability-related governance and AI-related governance, but not a simple opposition between a mature sustainability field and an immature AI field. Sustainability studies in the sample examine carbon disclosure (Jiang et al., 2023), institutional ownership (Azar et al., 2021), board

oversight (Velte, 2023; Cancela et al., 2020), regulation (Issa, 2024; Aboud et al., 2024), committees (Peters & Romi, 2014), and ESG measurement (Kurbus & Rant, 2025; Drempetic et al., 2020). AI studies examine adoption (Giordino et al., 2026), disclosure (Bonsón et al., 2021; Juma'h, 2026), ethical principles (Papagiannidis et al., 2025), accountability (Skeja & Sadiku-Dushi, 2026), and emerging oversight frameworks (Emett et al., 2026). The difference is therefore one of institutional depth and measurement, not the complete absence of governance on the AI side.

Proposition 2: Symbolic and Substantive Conformity

The reviewed evidence supports the coexistence of symbolic and substantive conformity in both fields, but it does not justify a simple classification of sustainability as substantive and AI as symbolic. Jiang et al. (2023) show that carbon disclosure can function as legitimacy management in high-carbon sectors but as a governance mechanism in low-carbon sectors. In AI, Juma'h (2026) shows that disclosure quality ranges from transparent and standards-aligned reporting to AI-washing. Symbolic and substantive practices therefore exist in both fields. What differs is the extent to which the field has developed the measures needed to distinguish between them.

Proposition 3: Convergence over Time

The reviewed evidence provides partial support for convergence. Similar mechanisms appear in both fields, including disclosure (Bonsón et al., 2021), boards (Elsayed & Ahmed, 2025), regulation (Aboud et al., 2024), and auditing (Colapinto et al., 2026; Islam et al., 2026). Solimene et al. (2025) report a worldwide convergence trend in CSR and ESG disclosure under institutional pressures. The AI-related board studies also show that governance mechanisms familiar from sustainability research are beginning to appear in AI research. At the same time, the small number of AI board studies, inconsistent AI disclosure, and lack of established AI metrics show that convergence has not yet been demonstrated as an outcome. The more defensible conclusion is that AI governance is moving toward some sustainability governance mechanisms, while developing additional mechanisms for risks that are specific to algorithmic systems.

The five themes therefore lead to a cautious overall conclusion. AI and sustainability governance share several instruments, but they do not yet have the same level of institutional support or measurement. Sustainability governance offers a point of comparison, not a

complete template. The results suggest that future AI governance will combine transferred mechanisms, such as board oversight and disclosure, with new forms of accountability designed for the speed, opacity, and organizational role of algorithmic systems.

5. Limitations

This review searched two databases, Scopus and Web of Science. Between them they give reasonable coverage of business and management journals, but AI governance research is also published in information systems, law, computer science, and social science outlets, and a two-database search will not have captured all of it. This is particularly relevant because the literature at the intersection of AI and sustainability governance appears to extend beyond core business and management categories; the subject-area restriction may therefore have reduced the visibility of precisely the studies that connect the two fields.

Section 3.1 already noted that the Q1/FT50 filter is a pragmatic, procedural stand-in for Cronin and George's (2020) balance requirement rather than a full implementation of it. That trade-off carries a cost here: journals that had not yet reached Q1 status, along with working papers, conference proceedings, and other early contributions, were excluded. This is particularly relevant for AI governance, since some of the most recent work in a fast-moving field may not yet have entered established rankings.

Screening and thematic classification were both carried out by a single reviewer, so inter-rater agreement could not be assessed. The criteria in Section 3.5 were applied consistently, but that consistency reflects one reviewer's judgment rather than an independently verified one.

Restricting the sample to English-language journal articles excludes work published in other languages, in books, at conferences, or in practitioner outlets.

This is an integrative review rather than a meta-analysis, and the included studies differ in theoretical foundation, research design, sample, and measures. The synthesis therefore identifies recurring patterns and conceptual relationships rather than a pooled effect, and its conclusions should not be read as causal claims about either governance domain.

Finally, the five-theme classification simplifies a body of research in which several articles addressed more than one governance mechanism. Each was assigned to the theme reflecting its main contribution, which keeps the cross-theme comparison legible but can obscure

connections between themes; no article should be read as belonging exclusively to the category it was placed in.

6. Conclusion

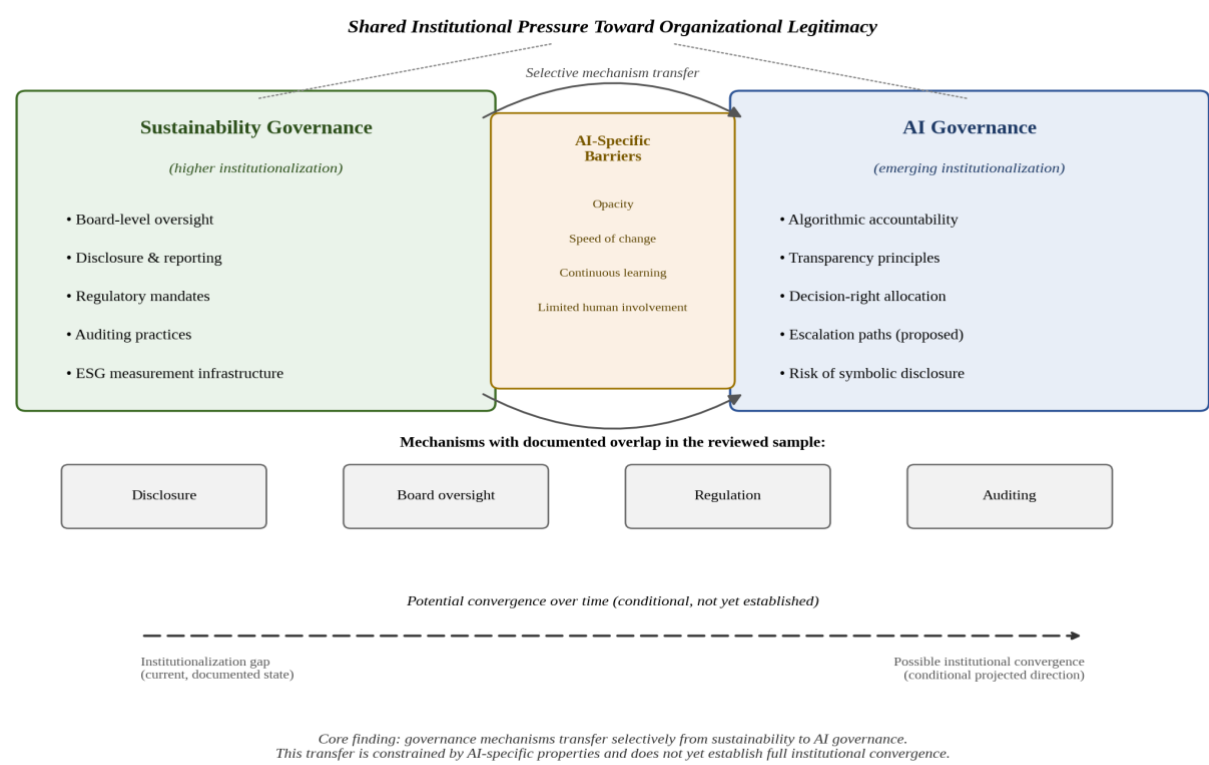


Figure 5. Conceptual Model of Governance Mechanism Transfer from Sustainability to AI Governance

The model above summarises the central finding of this review: AI governance selectively adopts mechanisms that are already familiar from sustainability governance, including disclosure, board oversight, regulation, and auditing. However, these mechanisms cannot be transferred without modification because algorithmic opacity, rapid technological change, continuous learning, and unclear responsibility require additional or adapted governance arrangements.

This chapter compared AI governance and sustainability governance across 93 studies and ten FT50 anchor articles. Using Institutional theory, it examined how organizations respond to governance pressure, how these responses become institutionalised, and why symbolic

and substantive practices coexist within both fields. The findings provide qualified support for all three propositions guiding the synthesis.

On the first research question, sustainability governance has more established reporting systems, measurement practices, board responsibilities, and regulatory mandates. AI governance is still developing comparable structures around algorithmic accountability, transparency, and the allocation of decision rights. This is a difference in institutional depth and measurement capacity, not a difference in kind between a substantive field and a symbolic one. On the second research question, the two fields already share mechanisms such as disclosure, board oversight, regulation, and auditing. These mechanisms cannot be adopted wholesale in AI governance, however, because algorithmic systems involve rapid technological change, opacity, continuous learning, and decisions made without direct human involvement, conditions that sustainability governance was not designed to address.

Proposition 1 receives qualified support. Sustainability governance demonstrates greater institutional depth through more established reporting systems, measurement practices, board responsibilities, and regulatory mandates. AI governance is developing comparable structures around algorithmic accountability, transparency, and decision-right allocation, but these mechanisms remain less standardized. The evidence therefore indicates institutional asymmetry, although it does not support a simple opposition between a mature sustainability field and an immature AI field.

Proposition 2 also receives qualified support. Symbolic and substantive conformity coexist in both fields rather than being neatly divided between sustainability governance and AI governance. Sustainability disclosure, carbon governance, and ESG measurement can support substantive accountability, but the same instruments can also produce rating disagreement, decoupling, and disclosure that signals compliance without corresponding changes in practice. AI governance shows a comparable tension between informative disclosure and AI-washing, as well as between ethical principles and their implementation. What differs is not the exclusive presence of symbolic or substantive practice, but the institutional depth and measurement capacity available to distinguish between them.

Proposition 3 receives partial support. Some governance mechanisms are beginning to transfer from sustainability governance to AI governance, but convergence has not yet

become an established institutional outcome. Disclosure, board oversight, regulation, and auditing provide relevant points of comparison, yet these mechanisms require modification in the AI context. Algorithmic opacity, rapid technological change, continuous learning, and unclear boundaries between human and system responsibility create governance conditions that sustainability mechanisms alone cannot fully address. The findings therefore support selective institutional transfer rather than automatic convergence.

Taken together, the three propositions receive qualified rather than unconditional support. Institutional asymmetry is real but not absolute, symbolic and substantive conformity occur in both fields, and some convergence is beginning to emerge without yet becoming an established institutional outcome.

The main contribution of this thesis is not to claim that AI governance and sustainability governance are the same. Rather, it provides a comparison showing which governance mechanisms can plausibly transfer from sustainability governance to AI governance and where such transfer is insufficient. Board oversight, disclosure, regulation, and auditing provide relevant points of comparison, while AI governance also requires additional mechanisms that address algorithmic opacity, rapid technological change, continuous learning, and the allocation of responsibility between humans and systems.

This conclusion is bounded by the limitations discussed in Section 5, particularly the two-database search, the English-language and journal restrictions, the Q1 and FT50 selection criteria, and the single-reviewer screening and classification process. The review is integrative rather than meta-analytic, and its conclusions identify recurring patterns and conceptual relationships rather than pooled effects or causal relationships.

Future research should move beyond mapping proposed AI-governance mechanisms and examine whether organizations implement them in practice. It should also test whether these mechanisms produce observable improvements in accountability, transparency, decision-making, and organizational outcomes across different industries, regulatory environments, and institutional contexts.

References

* Denotes references included among the 93 articles in the integrative literature review sample.

Abbasi, A., Parsons, J., Pant, G., Liu Sheng, O. R., & Sarker, S. (2024). Pathways for design research on artificial intelligence. *Information Systems Research*, 35(2), 441–459. <https://doi.org/10.1287/isre.2024.editorial.v35.n2>

*Abed, A., Al-Najjar, B., & Salama, A. (2025). Breaking down barriers: how board composition drives sustainability in GCC countries. *International Journal of Human Resource Management*, 36(4), 513-547. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09585192.2025.2452971>

*Aboud, A., Saleh, A., & Eliwa, Y. (2024). Does mandating ESG reporting reduce ESG decoupling? Evidence from the European Union's Directive 2014/95. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, 33(2), 1305-1320. <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.3543>

*Adamolekun, G., Ahmed, A., Kwansa, N. A., Lawal, R., & Sakariyahu, R. (2025). Corporate Climate Risk and Membership of Emission Trading Schemes. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.4286>

*Adobor, H. (2026). Navigating the AI adoption trap: A framework for organizational practice. *Organizational Dynamics*, 55(2). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.orgdyn.2026.101232>

*Ahdadou, M. (2026). From augmentation to autonomy: Artificial intelligence and the destabilization of agency in corporate governance. *Futures*, 182. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.futures.2026.103873>

*Ahdadou, M., Aajly, A., & Tahrouch, M. (2025). Enhancing corporate governance through AI: A systematic literature review. *Technology Analysis & Strategic Management*, 37(11), 1753–1766. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09537325.2024.2326120>

- *Ali, S., Farooq, M., Al-Jabri, Q., & Saleem, H. M. N. (2026). Board Governance as a Strategic Mechanism: Carbon Risk and Firm Performance. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 33(3), 3832-3850. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70358>
- *Alkaraan, F., Elmarzouky, M., Venkatesh, V. G., Hussainey, K., Shi, Y. Y., & Zhang, M. (2026). Artificial Intelligence-Powered Innovation Strategies for ESG Impact and Sustainable Ecosystems: A Natural-Resource-Based and Environmental-Legitimacy Perspective. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.70654>
- *Anathole, U., Cheng, L. M., & Hamza, F. (2026). Navigating Corporate Greenwashing in the Carbon Era: Synergizing Internal Carbon Pricing, ESG Governance, and Regulatory Stringency to Advance Environmental Integrity. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 33(2), 1794-1814. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70256>
- *Aras, G. & Crowther, D. (2008). Governance and sustainability: An investigation into the relationship between corporate governance and corporate sustainability. *Management Decision*, 46(3), 433-448. <https://doi.org/10.1108/00251740810863870>
- *Ardianto, A., Anridho, N., Cahyono, S., Alam, A. M. N., & Harymawan, I. (2024). The role of risk management committee on the relationship between corporate carbon emission disclosure and capital structure. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 31(3), 2127-2158. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.2671>
- *Awan, U., Ahmed, S., Albishri, N., Kalisz, D., & Szabó-Szentgróti, G. (2026). Organizational responsible AI implementation and organizational foresight: The role of leadership control and managerial cognitive flexibility. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 227. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2026.124623>

- *Azar, J., Duro, M., Kadach, I., & Ormazabal, G. (2021). The Big Three and corporate carbon emissions around the world. *Journal of Financial Economics*, 142(2), 674-696. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jfineco.2021.05.007>
- *Bansal, P. & Roth, K. (2000). Why companies go green: A model of ecological responsiveness. *Academy of Management Journal*, 43(4), 717-736. <https://doi.org/10.2307/1556363>
- Batool, A., Zowghi, D., & Bano, M. (2025). AI governance: A systematic literature review. *AI and Ethics*, 5(3), 3265–3279. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s43681-024-00653-w>
- *Bawa, S. & Asongu, S. (2026). Investigating How Firms in Emerging Economies Integrate AI-Driven Systems and ESG Metrics Into Biodiversity Conservation and Circular Economy Strategies. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, 35(5), 7420-7435. <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.70547>
- Berente, N., Gu, B., Recker, J., & Santhanam, R. (2021). Managing artificial intelligence. *MIS Quarterly*, 45(3), 1433–1450. <https://doi.org/10.25300/misq/2021/16274>
- *Bergougui, B., Sulimany, H. G. H., & Alharbi, A. A. (2026). Combating ESG Greenwashing Through AI Models: Evidence From Disaggregated AI Technologies, Mechanisms, and Thresholds. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70689>
- Berrone, P., Fosfuri, A., Gelabert, L., & Gómez-Mejía, L. R. (2013). Necessity as the mother of “green” inventions: Institutional pressures and environmental innovations. *Strategic Management Journal*, 34(8), 891–909. <https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.2041>
- Bohnsack, R., Pinkse, J., & Reischauer, G. (2026). Artificial intelligence and the twin transition: The good, the bad, and the ugly. *Industry and Innovation*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13662716.2026.2683371>

- Bolton, P., & Kacperczyk, M. (2021). Do investors care about carbon risk? *Journal of Financial Economics*, 142(2), 517–549.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jfineco.2021.05.008>
- Bonsón, E., Bednárová, M., & Perea, D. (2023). Disclosures about algorithmic decision making in the corporate reports of Western European companies. *International Journal of Accounting Information Systems*, 48.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.accinf.2022.100596>
- Bonsón, E., Lavorato, D., Lamboglia, R., & Mancini, D. (2021). Artificial intelligence activities and ethical approaches in leading listed companies in the European Union. *International Journal of Accounting Information Systems*, 43.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.accinf.2021.100535>
- *Bose, S., Burns, N., Minnick, K., & Shams, S. (2023). Climate-linked compensation, societal values, and climate change impact: International evidence. *Corporate Governance-An International Review*, 31(5), 759-785.
<https://doi.org/10.1111/corg.12504>
- Buchetti, Arduino & Perdichizzi (2025), *A Literature Review on Corporate Governance and ESG Research: Emerging Trends and Future Directions*, *International Review of Financial Analysis*, 97, 103759. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.irfa.2024.103759>
- *Buckley, P. J., Elia, S., Gaur, A., Krakowski, S., Kuivalainen, O., & Pedota, M. (2026). Artificial intelligence and international business: Theoretical challenges, strategic implications, and research agenda. *Journal of World Business*, 61(3).
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jwb.2025.101710>
- *Busch, T., Scheitza, L., Bauckloh, T., & Klein, C. (2025). Does Shareholder Signaling Matter for Corporate Strategy? A Study of ESG- and Carbon-Related Proposals. *Organization & Environment*, 38(3), 378-402.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/10860266251346248>

- *Cancela, B. L., Neves, M. E. D., Rodrigues, L. L., & Dias, A. C. G. (2020). The influence of corporate governance on corporate sustainability: new evidence using panel data in the Iberian macroeconomic environment. *International Journal of Accounting and Information Management*, 28(4), 785-806. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJAIM-05-2020-0068>
- Caro, F., Colliard, J.-E., Katok, E., Ockenfels, A., Stier-Moses, N., Tucker, C., & Wu, D. J. (2026). Introduction to the special issue on the human-algorithm connection. *Management Science*, 72(1), 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.2023.intro.v72.n1>
- *Chiu, S., Huang, C., Chiu, Y., & Tzeng, K. (2025). A Multi-Stage Efficiency Analysis of Taiwan's Semiconductor Industry: Integrating ESG and Artificial Intelligence Perspectives. *Business Ethics the Environment & Responsibility*, <https://doi.org/10.1111/beer.70054>
- *Colapinto, C., Galimberti, C., & Repetto, M. (2026). Auditing AI systems: Integrating ESG principles for sustainable and ethical AI deployment in the EU. *Technovation*, 156. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.technovation.2026.103600>
- *Cordeiro, C. M., Adomaitis, L., & Huang, L. (2026). The AI-policy-governance nexus: How regulation and AI shift corporate governance toward stakeholders. *Technology in Society*, 84. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techsoc.2025.103117>
- *Cordeiro, J. J. & Tewari, M. (2015). Firm Characteristics, Industry Context, and Investor Reactions to Environmental CSR: A Stakeholder Theory Approach. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 130(4), 833-849. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-014-2115-x>
- *Crifo, P., Escrig-Olmedo, E., & Mottis, N. (2019). Corporate Governance as a Key Driver of Corporate Sustainability in France: The Role of Board Members and Investor Relations. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 159(4), 1127-1146. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-018-3866-6>
- Cronin, M. A., & George, E. (2020). The why and how of the integrative review. *Organizational Research Methods*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1094428120935507>

- *Derchi, G. B., Davila, A., & Oyon, D. (2023). Green incentives for environmental goals. *Management Accounting Research*, 59. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.mar.2022.100830>
- DiMaggio, P. J., & Powell, W. W. (1983). The iron cage revisited: Institutional isomorphism and collective rationality in organizational fields. *American Sociological Review*, 48(2), 147–160. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2095101>
- *Dimes, R., de Villiers, C., Denny, P., & Leinonen, J. (2026). The Impact of Generative AI on the Perpetuation and Detection of Greenwashing in Sustainability Reports: Insights From an Experiment. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.70983>
- Döring, S., Drobetz, W., El Ghouli, S., Guedhami, O., & Schröder, H. (2023). Foreign Institutional Investors, Legal Origin, and Corporate Greenhouse Gas Emissions Disclosure. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 182(4), 903-932. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-022-05289-6>
- *Drempetic, S., Klein, C., & Zwergel, B. (2020). The Influence of Firm Size on the ESG Score: Corporate Sustainability Ratings Under Review. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 167(2), 333-360. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-019-04164-1>
- Durand, R., Hawn, O., & Ioannou, I. (2019). Willing and able: A general model of organizational responses to normative pressures. *Academy of Management Review*, 44(2), 299–320. <https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2016.0107>
- *Eccles, R. G., Ioannou, I., & Serafeim, G. (2014). The impact of corporate sustainability on organizational processes and performance. *Management Science*, 60(11), 2835-2857. <https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.2014.1984>
- Edmondson, A. C., & McManus, S. E. (2007). Methodological fit in management field research. *Academy of Management Review*, 32(4), 1246–1264. <https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.2007.26586086>

- *Elsayed, N. (2025). Strategic AI disclosures and legitimacy: Impression management in UK FTSE100 annual reports. *International Journal of Accounting Information Systems*, 56. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.accinf.2025.100757>
- *Elsayed, D. H. & Ahmed, E. A. (2025). Board of directors' attributes and artificial intelligence disclosure: evidence from Egyptian banks. *Journal of Financial Reporting and Accounting*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/JFRA-01-2025-0044>
- *Emett, S., Eulerich, M., Pikoos, J., & Wood, D. A. (2026). The Development of a Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) Governance Framework. *Accounting Horizons*, <https://doi.org/10.2308/HORIZONS-2025-056>
- Freeman, R. E. (1984). Strategic management: A stakeholder approach. Pitman. <https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9781139192675>
- Gillan, S. L. (2006). Recent developments in corporate governance: An overview. *Journal of Corporate Finance*, 12(3), 381–402. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jcorpfin.2005.11.002>
- *Giordino, D., Ballesio, E., Alshaghдали, N., & Galgotia, D. (2026). The relationship between organizational focus on AI, financial growth and sustainable development: Evidence from Europe. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 224. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2025.124499>
- *Gu, Y., Jiang, L. X., Dai, J., & Vasarhelyi, M. (2026). An LLM-based agentic system for greenwashing detection☆. *International Journal of Accounting Information Systems*, 57. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.accinf.2026.100780>
- *Hanisch, M., Goldsby, C. M., Fabian, N. E., & Oehmichen, J. (2023). Digital governance: A conceptual framework and research agenda. *Journal of Business Research*, 162. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2023.113777>
- *Hao, Y. & Rui, X. Y. (2026). Artificial intelligence policy and the distortion of green innovation: Evidence from a multi-period quasi-natural experiment. *Technological*

- *Hilb, M. (2020). Toward artificial governance? The role of artificial intelligence in shaping the future of corporate governance. *Journal of Management and Governance*, 24(4), 851-870. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10997-020-09519-9>

- *Huang, Y. Q. & Xu, C. H. (2026). Artificial Intelligence and Environmental Information Disclosure: The Roles of Green Innovation and Corporate Governance. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70726>

- *Hudson, K. & Morgan, R. E. (2026). Industry Exposure to Artificial Intelligence, Board Network Heterogeneity, and Firm Idiosyncratic Risk. *Journal of Management Studies*, 63(2), 596-630. <https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.13127>

- *Islam, M. S., Hussain, Z., Bansal, R., Awad, A., & Pruthi, N. (2026). AI-Enabled Environmental Auditing and Sustainability Disclosure: Green Reporting Capability as Mediator and Digital Compliance Culture as Moderator. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70565>

- *Issa, A. (2024). Do emissions reduction initiatives improve financial performance? Empirical analysis of moderating factors. *International Journal of Accounting and Information Management*, 32(2), 228-257. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJAIM-04-2023-0107>

- *Jain, T., Aguilera, R. V., & Jamali, D. (2017). Corporate Stakeholder Orientation in an Emerging Country Context: A Longitudinal Cross Industry Analysis. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 143(4), 701-719. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-016-3074-1>

- *Jiang, N., Wu, G., Zou, W. Y., & Chen, X. D. (2026). Responsible use of artificial intelligence and the mitigation of corporate greenwashing: The role of executive oversight. *Socio-Economic Planning Sciences*, 105. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.seps.2026.102436>

- *Jiang, Y., Fan, H. L., Zhu, Y., & Xu, J. F. (2023). Carbon disclosure: A legitimizing tool or a governance tool? Evidence from listed US companies. *Journal of International Financial Management & Accounting*, 34(1), 36-70. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jifm.12161>
- *Jin, S., Gan, C., & Li, Z. H. (2025). Climate governance and carbon transparency: evidence from nonfinancial firms. *Management Decision*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/MD-04-2024-0881>
- Juma'h, A. H. (2026). Artificial intelligence disclosure practices in US 10-K filings: accounting standards, signalling incentives and reporting quality. *Journal of Applied Accounting Research*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/JAAR-07-2025-0355>
- *Karaman, A. S., Uyar, A., Boussaada, R., & Karmani, M. (2024). Do investors care about greening in corporations? The role of eco-innovation and CSR committee. *Journal of Applied Accounting Research*, 25(5), 1244-1278. <https://doi.org/10.1108/JAAR-10-2023-0289>
- *Kathuria, A., Karhade, P. P., Malik, O., Baruri, V. K. P., & Konsynski, B. R. (2026). AI Governance and the Decentralization of Technology Production: An Investigation of AI-Based IPA Bots. *Information Systems Research*, <https://doi.org/10.1287/isre.2023.0588>
- *Khalid, F., Srivastava, M., & Toumi, F. (2025). AI technology adoption and corporate financial misconduct. *Journal of Financial Reporting and Accounting*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/JFRA-06-2025-0474>
- *Klettner, A., Clarke, T., & Boersma, M. (2014). The Governance of Corporate Sustainability: Empirical Insights into the Development, Leadership and Implementation of Responsible Business Strategy. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 122(1), 145-165. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-013-1750-y>

- *Kumar, N., Wei, X. H., & Zhang, H. (2026). Agentic artificial intelligence as a new frontier in information systems: Promise, peril, and research opportunities. *Information & Management*, 63(3). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.im.2026.104317>
- *Kurbus, B. & Rant, V. (2025). A legal origins perspective on ESG rating disagreement. *Research in International Business and Finance*, 74. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ribaf.2024.102702>
- *Kurnia, P., Agustia, D., Soewarno, N., & Ardianto, A. (2025). The mediating role of carbon emission disclosure in the relationship between structure of corporate governance and firm performance. *Journal of Applied Accounting Research*, 26(5), 1106-1134. <https://doi.org/10.1108/JAAR-01-2023-0015>
- *Li, Y. H., Lin, Z. W., & Zhang, Z. P. (2026). Institutional investors and corporate carbon emissions: evidence from China. *International Journal of Emerging Markets*, 21(7), 2186-2206. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJOEM-08-2024-1425>
- Liang, H., & Renneboog, L. (2017). On the foundations of corporate social responsibility. *The Journal of Finance*, 72(2), 853–910. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jofi.12487>
- *Lin, B. Q. & Xie, Y. J. (2024). Impacts of digital transformation on corporate green technology innovation: Do board characteristics play a role?. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 31(3), 1741-1755. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.2653>
- *Liu, M., Almugren, I., Chotia, V., Sahore, N., & Kurucz, A. (2026). Experiential learning and governance in the socio-technical era: Modeling responsible AI performance via explainability and adaptability. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 227. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2026.124624>
- *Lohia, P. & Maji, S. G. (2025). ESG Disclosures, Legal Systems and Market Value in High-Impact Economies: A Stakeholder Capitalism Perspective. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 32(5), 6181-6199. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70026>

- *Luo, K., Xue, J. L., Rassiah, P., & Lim, E. K. (2026). Smart accountability: leveraging AI to align ESG disclosure with practice. *International Journal of Accounting Information Systems*, 57. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.accinf.2026.100773>
- *Manning, B., Braam, G., & Reimsbach, D. (2019). Corporate governance and sustainable business conduct-Effects of board monitoring effectiveness and stakeholder engagement on corporate sustainability performance and disclosure choices. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 26(2), 351-366. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.1687>
- *Mu, T. T., Shan, Q. J., Zhu, G. Y., Xu, Y., Agag, G., & Alipour, O. (2026). Beyond technology: The dual role of AI and narratives in driving ESG performance in China's retail industry. *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, 90. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jretconser.2025.104675>
- *Muktadir-Al-Mukit, D. & Bhaiyat, F. H. (2024). Impact of corporate governance diversity on carbon emission under environmental policy via the mandatory nonfinancial reporting regulation. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, 33(2), 1397-1417. <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.3555>
- *Nahum, N., Larsson-Olaison, U., Uman, T., & Achtenhagen, L. (2026). Corporate governance for digital transformation: The role of ownership and the board of directors. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 223. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2025.124453>
- *Papagiannidis, E., Mikalef, P., & Conboy, K. (2025). Responsible artificial intelligence governance: A review and research framework. *Journal of Strategic Information Systems*, 34(2). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jsis.2024.101885>
- *Patra, S. P. (2026). Strategic governance of algorithmic decision systems in organizations. *Journal of Strategy and Management*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/JSMA-03-2026-0179>

- *Peng, C. & Chen, Y. S. (2024). Informal board hierarchy and corporate ESG performance. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 31(5), 4783-4795. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.2834>
- *Peters, G. F. & Romi, A. M. (2014). Does the Voluntary Adoption of Corporate Governance Mechanisms Improve Environmental Risk Disclosures? Evidence from Greenhouse Gas Emission Accounting. *Journal of Business Ethics*, 125(4), 637-666. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-013-1886-9>
- *Qalati, S. A. & Siddiqui, F. (2026). Organizational sustainable artificial intelligence capabilities scale development, validation, and implications. *Journal of Innovation & Knowledge*, 11. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jik.2025.100863>
- *Riyath, M. I. M. & Jariya, A. M. I. (2024). The role of ESG reporting, artificial intelligence, stakeholders and innovation performance in fostering sustainability culture and climate resilience. *Journal of Financial Reporting and Accounting*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/JFRA-10-2023-0621>
- *Romeo, E., Rosa, A., Durst, S., & Smrcka, L. (2026). Navigating the AI Frontier: a holistic framework for algorithmic governance and responsible innovation in organizations. *Management Decision*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/MD-09-2025-2615>
- *Roszkowska-Menkes, M., Aluchna, M., & Kaminski, B. (2024). True transparency or mere decoupling? The study of selective disclosure in sustainability reporting. *Critical Perspectives On Accounting*, 98. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cpa.2023.102700>
- *Shen, H., Zhang, L. R., Bonsu, M., & Kaodui, L. (2026). Driving Sustainability Through Artificial Intelligence and Financial Innovation: The Roles of Green Innovation and Information Transparency in China. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.70728>

- *Skeja, A. & Sadiku-Dushi, N. (2026). Toward sustainable AI leadership: ethical blind spots, accountability gaps and the CARE governance framework. *Leadership & Organization Development Journal*, 47(2), 336-354. <https://doi.org/10.1108/LODJ-06-2025-0530>
- *Solimene, S., Coluccia, D., Fontana, S., & Bernardo, A. (2025). Formal Institutions and Voluntary CSR/ESG Disclosure: The Role of Institutional Diversity and Firm Size. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, 32(4), 5147-5166. <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.3195>
- *Song, Y. H., Mi, L., Bian, Z., Tu, W., & He, J. (2025). How does artificial intelligence impact corporate ESG performance? The catching-up effect of digital technological innovation. *Journal of Innovation & Knowledge*, 10(6). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jik.2025.100843>
- *Stacchezzini, R., Melloni, G., & Lai, A. (2016). Sustainability management and reporting: the role of integrated reporting for communicating corporate sustainability management. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 136, 102-110. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2016.01.109>
- Suchman, M. C. (1995). Managing legitimacy: Strategic and institutional approaches. *Academy of Management Review*, 20(3), 571–610. <https://doi.org/10.5465/amr.1995.9508080331>
- Surroca, J., Tribó, J. A., & Waddock, S. (2010). Corporate responsibility and financial performance: The role of intangible resources. *Strategic Management Journal*, 31(5), 463–490. <https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.820>
- *Syed, A. M. & Sangmi, M. U. D. (2026). Testing the Transformative Promise: Voluntary Integrated Reporting and Its ESG Consequences. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.70977>
- *Tian, B. W., Deng, Z. H., Gulzar, M. A., & Yu, J. Y. (2026). Artificial Intelligence and the Rise of Corporate Digital Responsibility: Unlocking Ethical Governance. *Corporate*

Social Responsibility and Environmental Management, 33(2), 1954-1969.
<https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70254>

- Tong, S., Jia, N., Luo, X., & Fang, Z. (2021). The Janus face of artificial intelligence feedback: Deployment versus disclosure effects on employee performance. *Strategic Management Journal*, 42(9), 1600–1631. <https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.3322>
- *Tsang, A., Wang, K. T., Liu, S. M., & Yu, L. (2021). Integrating corporate social responsibility criteria into executive compensation and firm innovation: International evidence. *Journal of Corporate Finance*, 70. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jcorpfin.2021.102070>
- Turner, S.F., Cardinal, L.B., & Burton, R. M. (2017). Research design for mixed methods: A triangulation-based framework and roadmap, *Organizational Research Methods*, 20(2), 243–267. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1094428115610808>
- *Velte, P. (2024). Sustainable board governance and sustainable supply chain reporting: European evidence. *Journal of Strategy and Management*, 17(2), 222-243. <https://doi.org/10.1108/JSMA-07-2023-0189>
- *Velte, P. (2023). Does sustainable board governance drive corporate social responsibility? A structured literature review on European archival research. *Journal of Global Responsibility*, 14(1), 46-88. <https://doi.org/10.1108/JGR-05-2022-0044>
- *Velte, P. (2023). Which institutional investors drive corporate sustainability? A systematic literature review. *Business Strategy and the Environment*, 32(1), 42-71. <https://doi.org/10.1002/bse.3117>
- *Wang, T., Feng, M., & Shen, Y. (2025). Towards a technological future: exploring how human-AI collaboration enhances corporate low-carbon transformation performance. *Industrial Management and Data Systems*, 1-25. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IMDS-07-2025-0954>

- *Xia, H. S., Chen, H., Zhang, J. Z., & Kamal, M. M. (2026). Exploring the impact of responsible AI governance on corporate performance: A quasi-natural experiment. *Technological Forecasting and Social Change*, 223. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.techfore.2025.124425>
- *Xiong, M. R., Xu, H. F., Ji, J., Zuo, R. X., Wang, Y. C., & Olya, H. (2026). Responsible Artificial Intelligence Attention and Firm Innovation: An Attention-Based View. *Journal of Product Innovation Management*, 43(1), 186-214. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jpim.70015>
- *Xu, Z. Y., Du, Z. Q., Gao, Y. T., & Ma, J. F. (2026). Retail investors' green attention and corporate carbon emissions: evidence from China. *Social Responsibility Journal*, 22(3), 596-616. <https://doi.org/10.1108/SRJ-03-2025-0184>
- *Yadav, A. & Asongu, S. A. (2026). The AI Sustainability Paradox: How Verification and Regulation Synergize to Curb Greenwashing in Emerging Markets. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, <https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.70737>
- *Yang, Y. F., Zhang, J. X., Zhang, X., Chen, C. Y., & Dong, C. W. (2026). Artificial intelligence as a catalyst for ESG improvement: mechanisms and empirical evidence from manufacturing enterprises. *Journal of Business Research*, 215. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2026.116302>
- *Yang, Y. M., Long, J. Y., Yu, S. R., Zeng, X. W., Li, H. L., & Yi, C. Q. (2025). The impact of green credit on ESG performance of Chinese manufacturing firms: the mediating role of knowledge diversity and artificial intelligence application. *Journal of Knowledge Management*, <https://doi.org/10.1108/JKM-01-2025-0099>
- *Zhang, J. F. (2025). Artificial intelligence and green innovation: Investigating the effects of executive pay and firm age. *Research in International Business and Finance*, 77. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ribaf.2025.102953>

- *Zhou, Y. Q., Chen, L. H., Zhou, F. F., & Ye, M. R. (2026). Contractual arrangements and information consistency: How ESG executive compensation incentives affect corporate AI disclosure. *Journal of Business Research*, 207. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2026.116019>
- *Zhou, Z. X., Zhou, X. Y., Zhang, X. Z., & He, Q. (2025). Not all sparks ignite the same flame: Firm AI innovation and ESG performance. *Journal of Business Research*, 201. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2025.115738>

AI report: tracking the steps

Section of the thesis	Prompt Used	Sub Prompt Used	Comments: steps you edited/changed + reason
Introduction	Corrected specific citation and wording issues in the drafted introduction (e.g., checking whether Gillan & Starks (1998) actually supports a general corporate-governance definition or is specifically about shareholder activism, fixing typos, checking a flagged sentence I had marked for review)	Asked for verification against the actual content of the cited sources before applying any change	The introduction's argument and structure are my own. I only accepted the citation swap after independently checking that Gillan & Starks (1998) is a shareholder-activism paper, not a general governance definition, and used Gillan (2006) instead. I fixed the wording myself for the sentence I had flagged; the AI only located the flagged text and typos
Methodology Keyword search Article selection Filtering of the articles	cross-checking the keywords I had selected against the actual keyword fields and full text of each source, and formatting the search/screening counts I had already produced into the PRISMA-style flow diagram and search-results summary tables	Requested re-checks when an initially assigned keyword did not literally match the source article (e.g., correcting an assigned term to the literal keyword used by Tong et al.), and asked for the keyword-cluster fit of specific articles to be flagged where uncertain	All search, screening, and inclusion/exclusion numbers are mine, generated from my own database searches. The AI only formatted these into and cross-checked keyword assignments against source text. I reviewed and personally corrected several keyword-to-cluster assignments before finalizing
Results and Findings	Checked the article's classification against my coding rule and flagged inconsistencies	Directed repeated re-checks against my own coding rule and the original PDFs whenever I spotted an error	coding rules and final classifications are mine. I corrected the AI's output myself wherever it was wrong and approved every final wording
Conclusion	Reviewed the conclusion paragraph for logical flow and check whether it aligns with the findings I described earlier	Directed wording adjustments to keep claims aligned with my evidence	Propositions, findings, and argument are mine. The AI feedback only led to small adjustments in sentences where the logical flow between paragraphs felt off

Declaration of Authorship

I hereby declare that this master's thesis, entitled "AI Corporate Governance versus Sustainability Corporate Governance: An Integrative Literature Review", is my own original work and that I have not used any sources or aids other than those cited. All passages taken from published or unpublished works, whether verbatim or in substance, have been identified as such. This thesis has not been submitted, in whole or in part, to any other examination authority and has not been published previously.

Barcelona, 25.08.2026



Larissa Gagesch